NATIONAL MULTIDIMENSIONAL POVERTY INDEX

A Progress Review 2023

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Overview

Home to one-sixth of humanity and to more young minds than any other country, India plays a decisive role in Agenda 2030. At the core of India's development agenda is the elimination of poverty in all its forms, ensuring that no individual is left behind.

Historically, poverty estimation has predominantly relied on income as the sole indicator. However, the Global Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI), based on the Alkire-Foster (AF) methodology, captures overlapping deprivations in health, education, and living standards. It complements income poverty measurements because it measures and compares deprivations directly. The global MPI Report is jointly published by the Oxford Poverty and Human Development Initiative (OPHI) and the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP).

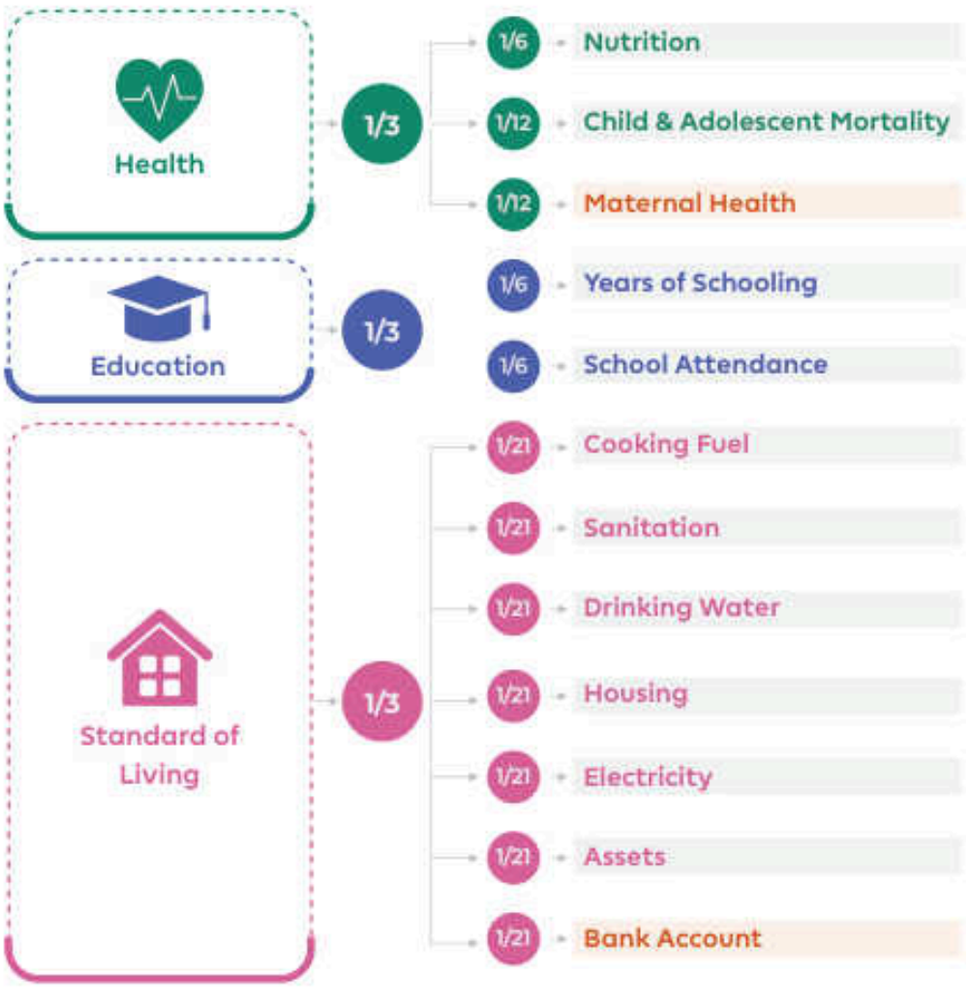
Government of India has acknowledged the significance of the global MPI under the mandate of the Global Indices for Reform and Action (GIRG) initiative. The emphasis of the GIRG initiative is not only to improve the country's performance and ranking in the global indices, but also to leverage the indices as tools for driving systemic reforms and growth.

In this context, NITI Aayog, as the nodal agency for MPI, has been responsible for constructing an indigenized index for monitoring the performance of States and Union Territories in addressing multidimensional poverty. In order to institutionalize this, NITI Aayog constituted an inter-ministerial MPI Coordination Committee (MPICC) including Ministries and departments pertaining to areas such as health, education, nutrition, rural development, drinking water, sanitation, electricity, and urban development, among others. It also included experts from the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) and technical partners – OPHI and UNDP. The composition of the MPICC drew from the multidimensional nature of the indicators and sub-indicators within the index. This brought forth cross-sectoral perspectives on policies and interventions needed to improve achievements at the level of households.

As a result of extensive consultations held within MPICC, the dual-cutoff approach of the AF methodology – the one used in the Global MPI Report – was considered suitable for the national MPI. The national MPI model retains the ten indicators of the global MPI model, staying closely aligned to the global methodology. It also adds two indicators, viz., Maternal Health and Bank Accounts in line with national priorities.

Like the global MPI, India's national MPI has three equally weighted dimensions – Health, Education, and Standard of living – which are represented by 12 indicators. These are depicted by the following graphic:

Indicators and their weights



Sub-indices of the National MPI

The indices of the national MPI comprise:

i) Headcount ratio (H): How many are poor?

Proportion of multidimensionally poor in the population, which is arrived at by dividing number of multidimensionally poor persons by total population.

ii) Intensity of poverty (A): How poor are the poor?

Average proportion of deprivations which is experienced by multidimensionally poor individuals. To compute intensity, the weighted deprivation scores of all poor people are summed and then divided by the total number of poor people.

MPI value is arrived at by multiplying the headcount ratio (H) and the intensity of poverty (A), reflecting both the share of people in poverty and the degree to which they are deprived.

$$MPI = H \times A$$

According to the AF methodology, an individual is considered MPI poor if their deprivation score equals or exceeds the poverty cutoff of 33.33%.

The national Multidimensional Poverty Index plays a pivotal role in assessing advancements towards target 1.2 of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) which aims at reducing "at least by half the proportion of men, women and children of all ages living in poverty in all its dimensions". NITI Aayog published the national MPI Baseline Report in November 2021, with estimates computed using the data from the 4th round of the National Family Health Survey (NFHS-4) conducted in 2015-16.

Introduction to the Second Edition

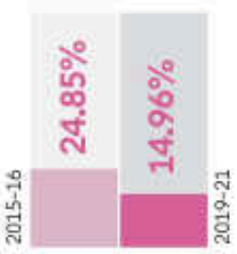
The National Multidimensional Poverty Index: A Progress Review 2023 presents the second edition of the national MPI and is a follow-up to the Baseline Report published in November 2021. It provides multidimensional poverty estimates for India's 36 States & Union Territories, along with 707 administrative districts across 12 indicators of the national MPI. These estimates have been computed using data from the 5th round of the NFHS (NFHS-5) conducted in 2019-21, employing the same methodology as the baseline report. This edition also presents the changes in multidimensional poverty between the survey periods of NFHS-4 (2015-16) and NFHS-5 (2019-21).

Key Results – Steep Decline in Poverty

India has achieved a remarkable reduction in its MPI value and Headcount Ratio between 2015-16 and 2019-21, indicating success of the country's commitment and action to address the multidimensional nature of poverty through its multisectoral approach.

Highlights: MPI Progress Report 2023

Steep decline in
Poverty Headcount Ratio



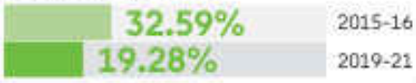
135 million (13.5 crore)
people escaped multidimensional poverty between 2015-16 and 2019-21



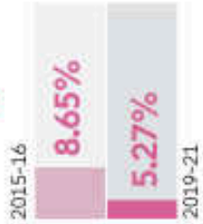
India on track to achieve
SDG Target 1.2
(reducing multi-dimensional poverty by at least half) much ahead of 2030

All 12 indicators have shown improvement
suggesting that impact of Government interventions is increasingly visible on ground

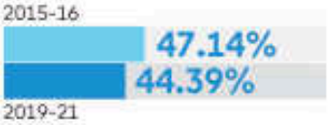
Fastest decline in percentage of multidimensional poor in rural areas from



Reduction in the incidence of poverty in urban areas



The **Intensity of poverty,** which measures the average deprivation among the people living in multidimensional poverty improved from about





UP, Bihar, MP, Odisha and Rajasthan recorded steepest decline in number of **MPI poor**



Improvement in **nutrition, years of schooling, sanitation, and cooking fuel** played a significant role in reducing the MPI value

Snapshot of Multidimensional Poverty in India			
Year	Headcount Ratio (H)	Intensity of Poverty (A)	MPI (H x A)
2019-21	14.96%	44.39%	0.066
2015-16	24.85%	47.14%	0.117

The MPI estimates highlight a near-halving of India's national MPI value and decline in the proportion of population in multidimensional poverty from 24.85% to 14.96% between 2015-16 and 2019-21. This reduction of 9.89 percentage points in multidimensional poverty indicates that, at the level of projected population in 2021, about 135.5 million persons have escaped poverty between 2015-16 and 2019-21. It is a major contribution towards achieving SDG target 1.2 that aims to reduce "at least by half the proportion of men, women and children of all ages living in poverty in all its dimensions according to national definitions". This indicates that India is well on course to achieve the SDG target 1.2 much ahead of 2030. At the same time, the Intensity of Poverty, which measures the average deprivation among the people living in multidimensional poverty also reduced from 47.14% to 44.39%.

Disparities across Rural and Urban Areas

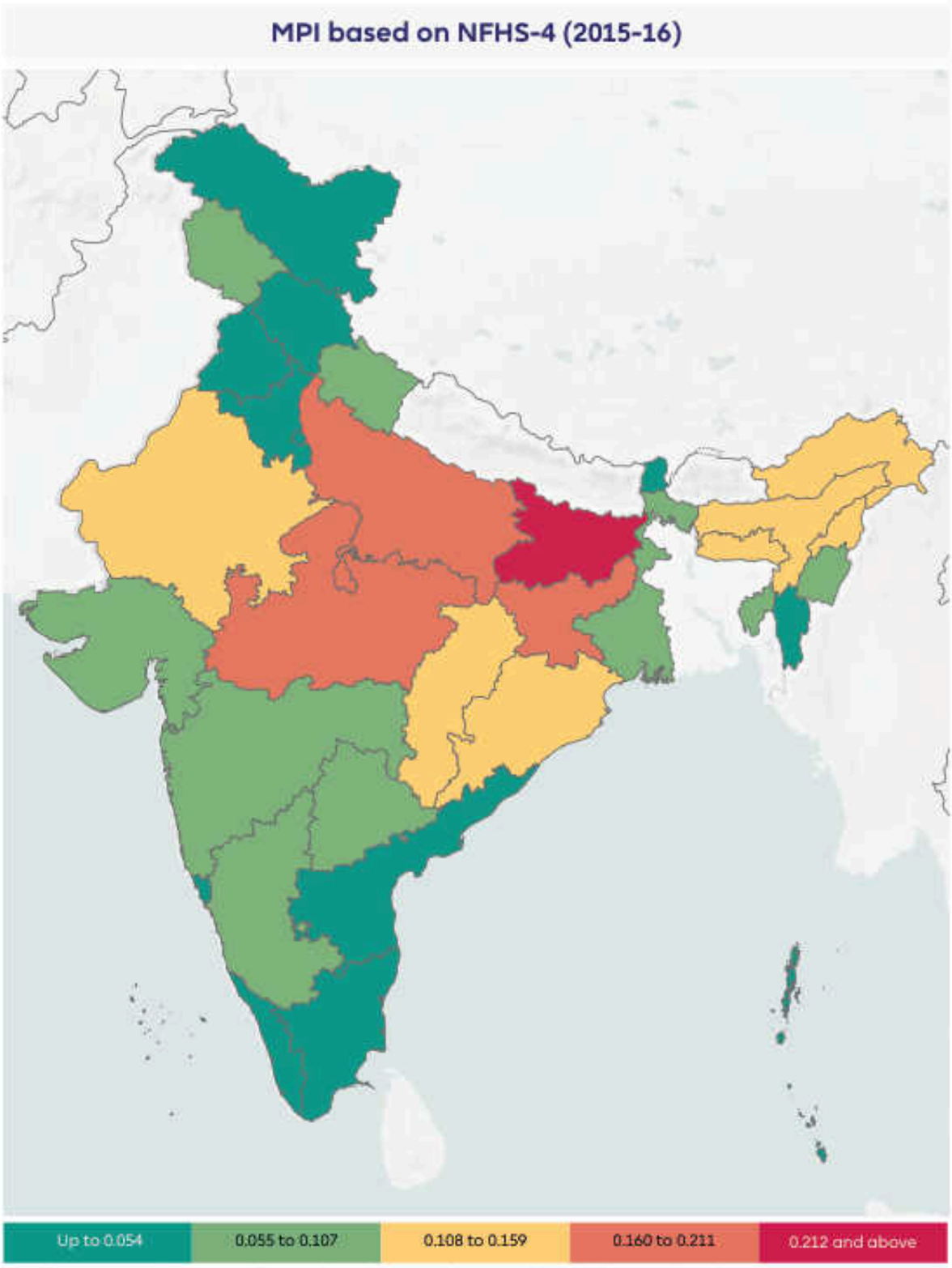
While disparities in multidimensional poverty still exist between rural and urban areas, with the proportion of multidimensional poor in 2019-21 being 19.28% in rural areas compared to 5.27% in urban areas, the reduction in the MPI value has been pro-poor in absolute terms.

Year	Rural			Urban		
	MPI	Headcount Ratio (H)	Intensity of Poverty (A)	MPI	Headcount Ratio (H)	Intensity of Poverty (A)
2019-21	0.086	19.28%	44.55%	0.023	5.27%	43.10%
2015-16	0.154	32.59%	47.38%	0.039	8.65%	45.27%

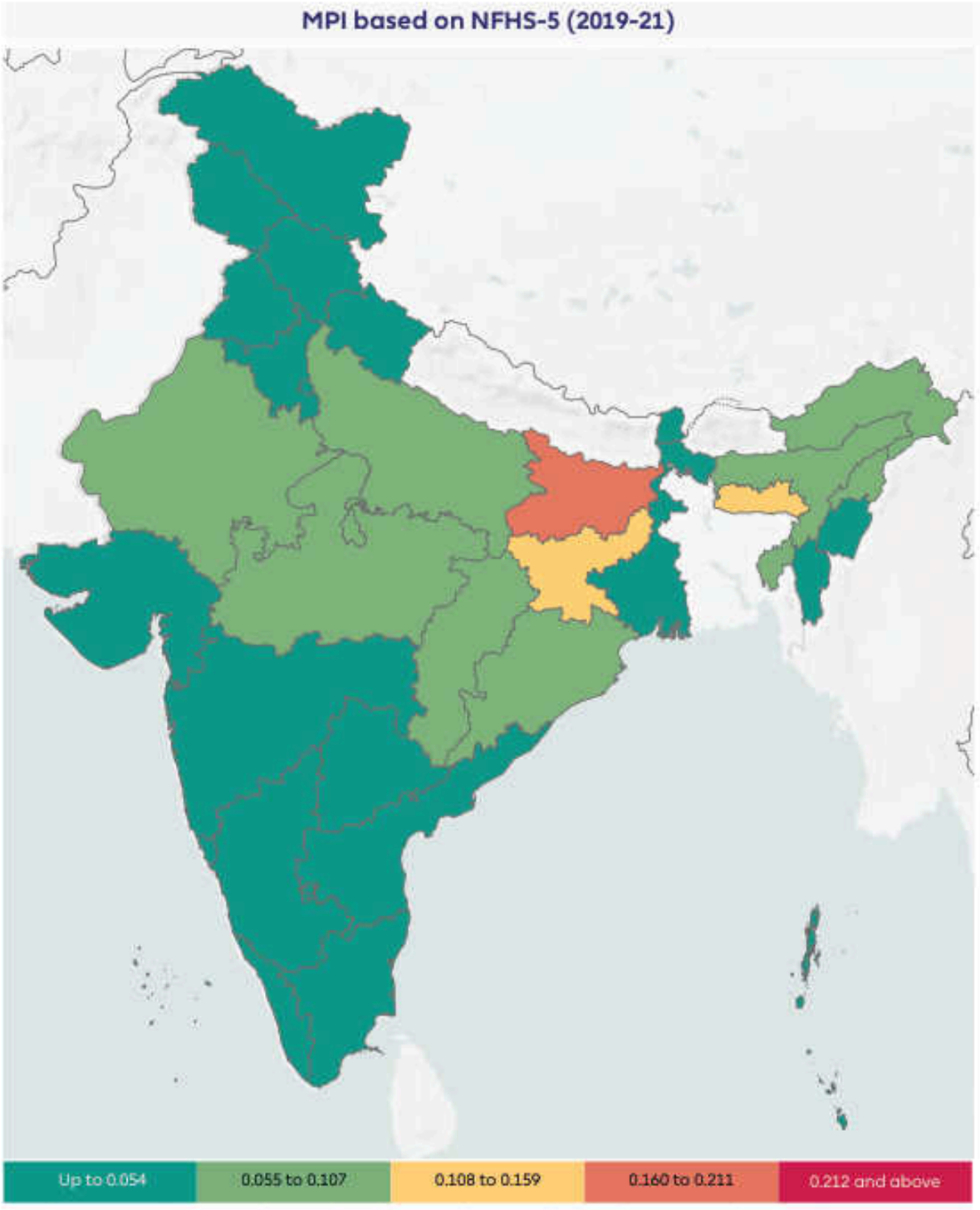
The estimates indicate that rural areas saw a faster reduction in their MPI value, compared to urban areas. The incidence of poverty fell from 32.59% to 19.28% in rural areas compared to a decline from 8.65% to 5.27% in urban areas between 2015-16 and 2019-21.

Comparative Performance of States/UTs in the Multidimensional Poverty Index Score

The MPI estimates show that States/UTs have displayed notable improvements in their MPI score from 2015-16 to 2019-21.



The colour represents the MPI score of a state. The colour moves from green, through yellow, to red as the MPI score increases. Green represents areas with the lowest MPI scores while red represents areas with the highest MPI scores. The legend shows the range of MPI scores in India, based on the values for 2015-16. Both the comparative maps use the same legend to represent the change in MPI scores between 2015-16 to 2019-21.



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Fastest Absolute Reduction in MPI (State-wise)

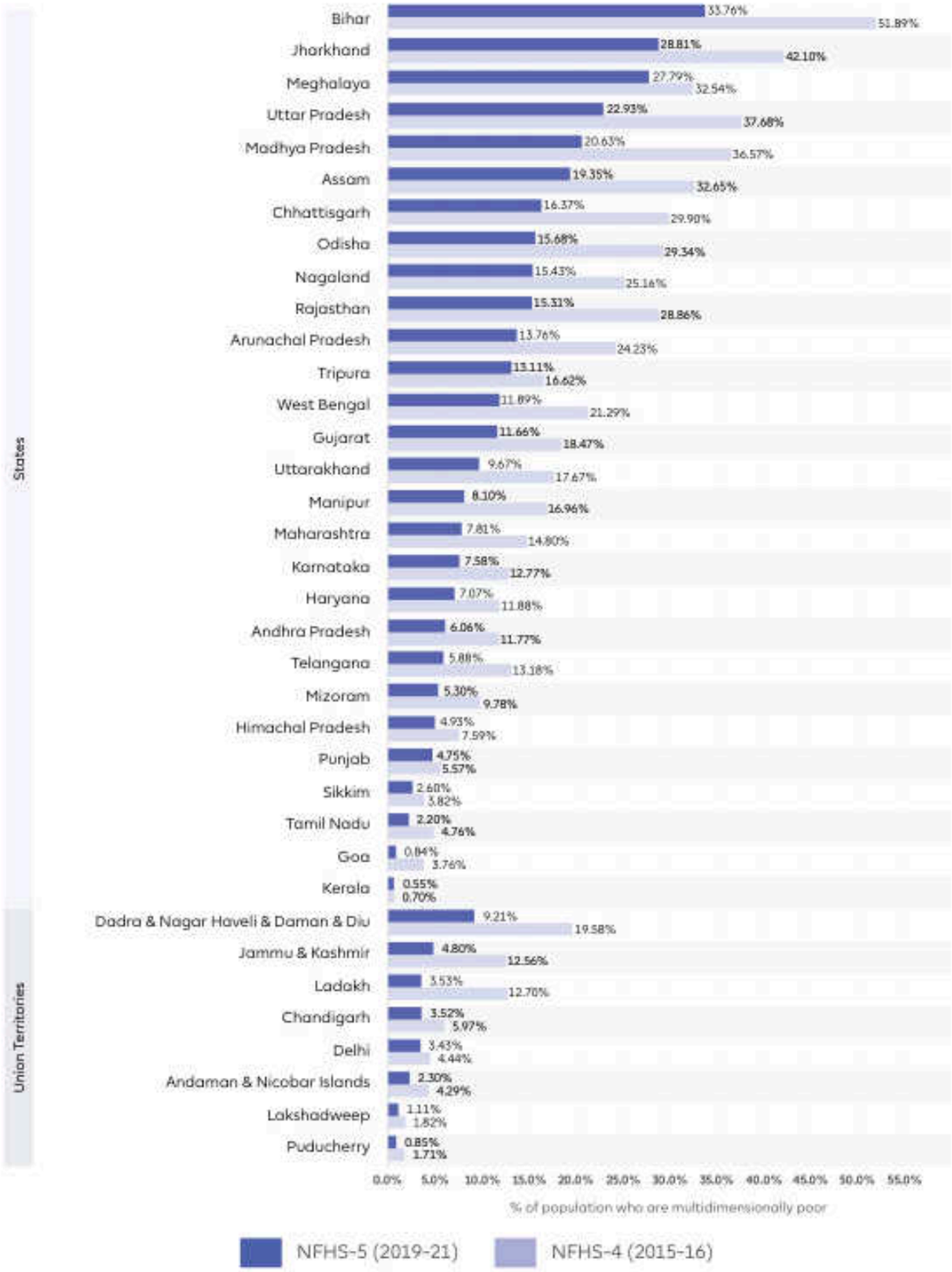
Bihar, the state with the highest MPI value in NFHS-4 (2015-16), saw the fastest reduction in MPI value in absolute terms with the proportion of multidimensional poor reducing from 51.89% to 33.76% in 2019-21. The next fastest reduction in the MPI value was seen in Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh. The proportion of multidimensional poor in Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh in NFHS-5 (2019-21) are 20.63% and 22.93% respectively. In terms of number of MPI poor, Uttar Pradesh topped the list with 3.43 crore people escaping multidimensional poverty in the last five years, followed by Bihar (2.25 crore) and Madhya Pradesh (1.36 crore).

Performance of States/UTs in Headcount Ratio

It is crucial to recognize the efforts of the States and UTs in reducing the proportion of multidimensional poor people in the country. The progress of each State and UT between the two periods is indicated below.

India : Headcount Ratio

Percentage of the total population who are multidimensionally poor in each State and UT

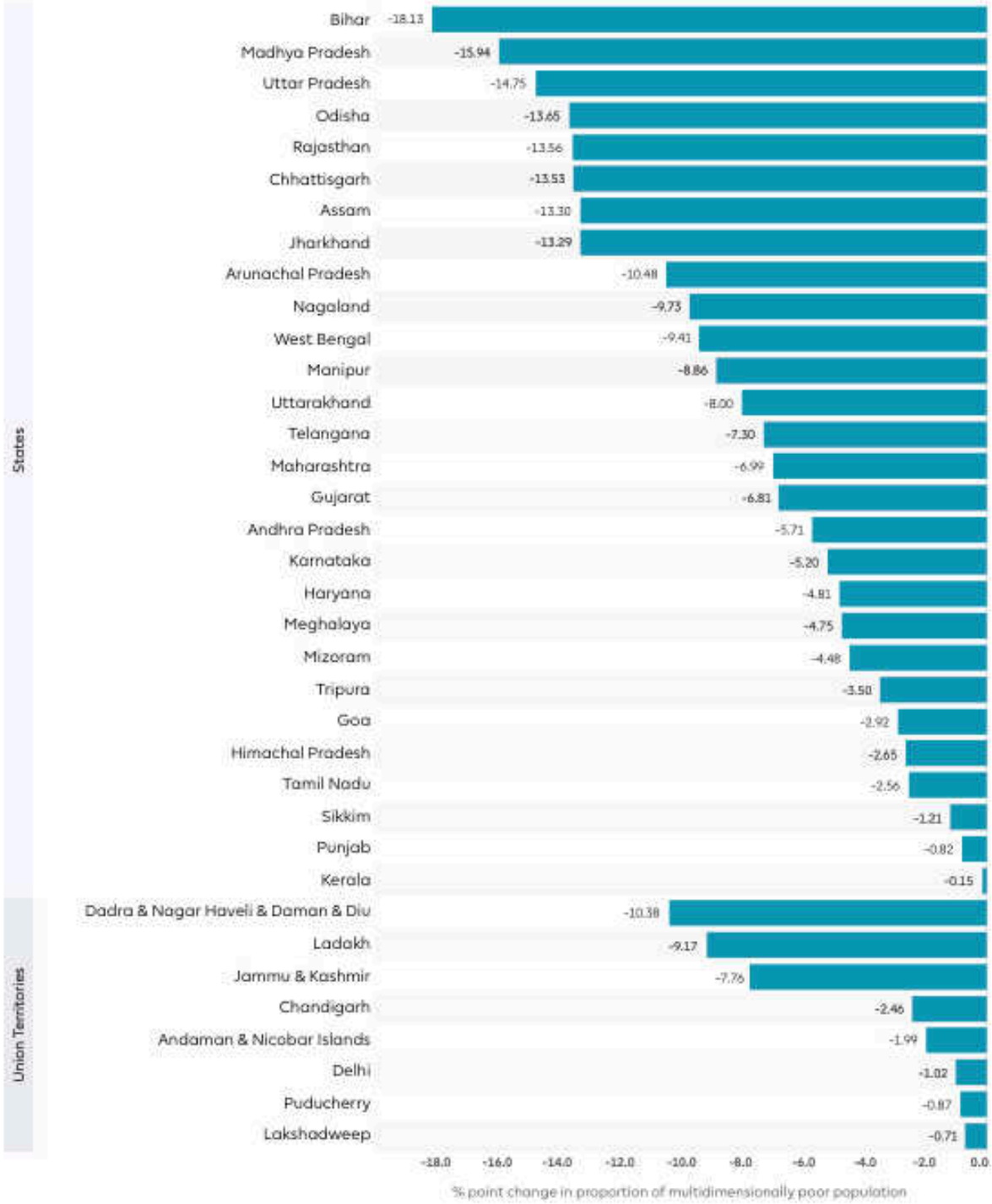


Changes over Time for Headcount Ratio

The estimates indicate an overall improvement in the proportion of multidimensional poor in States and UTs between the time period 2015-16 to 2019-21.

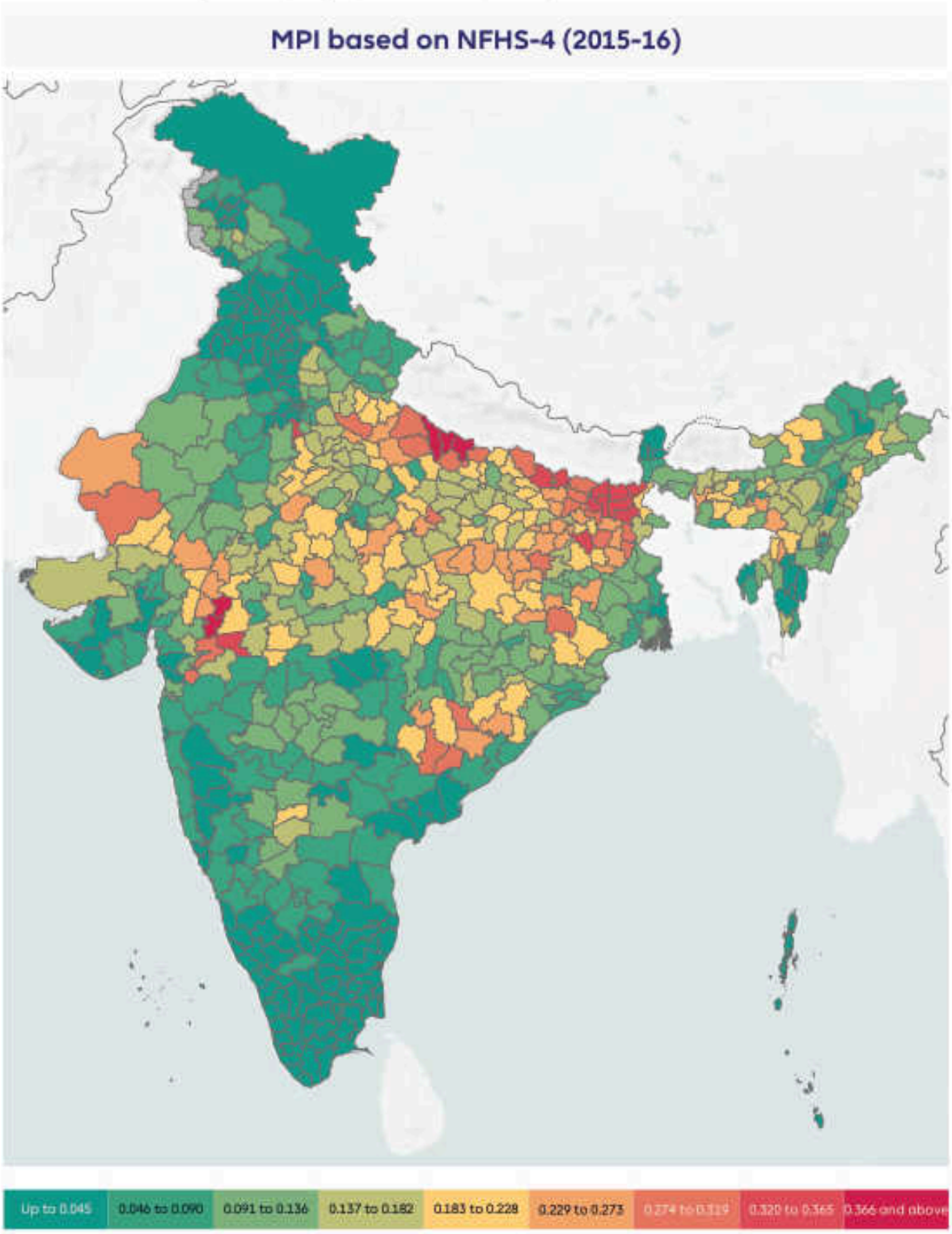
India : Changes over time for Headcount Ratio

State/ UT wise percentage point change in the headcount ratio between 2015-16 and 2019-21



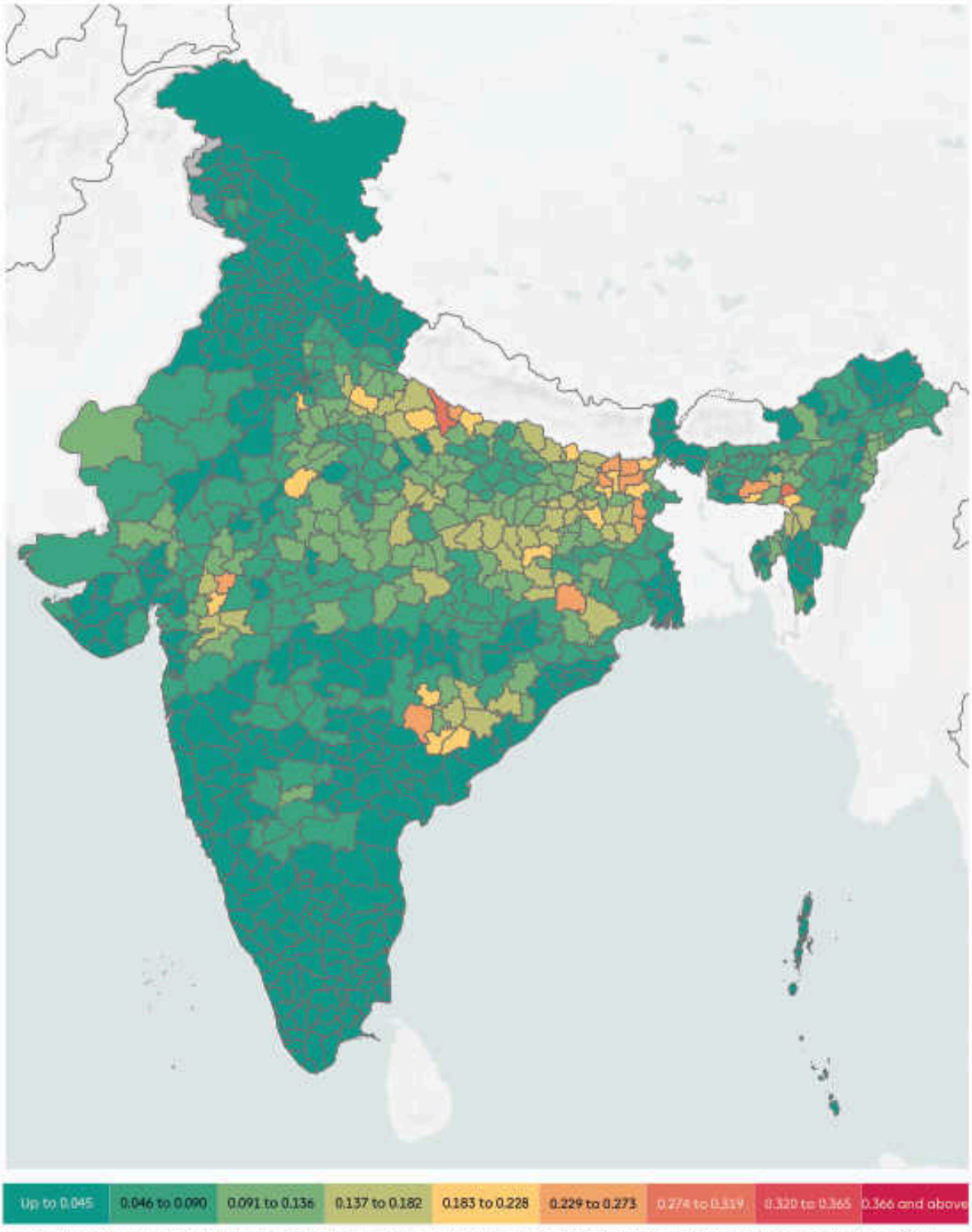
Comparative Performance of Districts in the Multidimensional Poverty Index Score

An important characteristic of the MPI is its ability to provide estimates at the district level. The disaggregated estimates show that the most rapid reduction in the proportion of multidimensionally poor individuals occurred in districts located within the states of Madhya Pradesh, Gujarat, Uttar Pradesh, and Rajasthan.



The colour represents the MPI score of a district. The colour moves from green, through yellow, to red as the MPI score increases. Green represents areas with the lowest MPI scores while red represents areas with the highest MPI scores. The legend shows the range of MPI scores in India, based on values for 2015-16. Both the comparative maps use the same legend to represent the change in MPI scores between 2015-16 to 2019-21. Regions where data is not available is shown in grey. Only 575 districts are comparable between the two time periods of the two NFHS (2015-16 and 2019-21). Of these, 436 districts are statistically significant at 95% level of confidence.

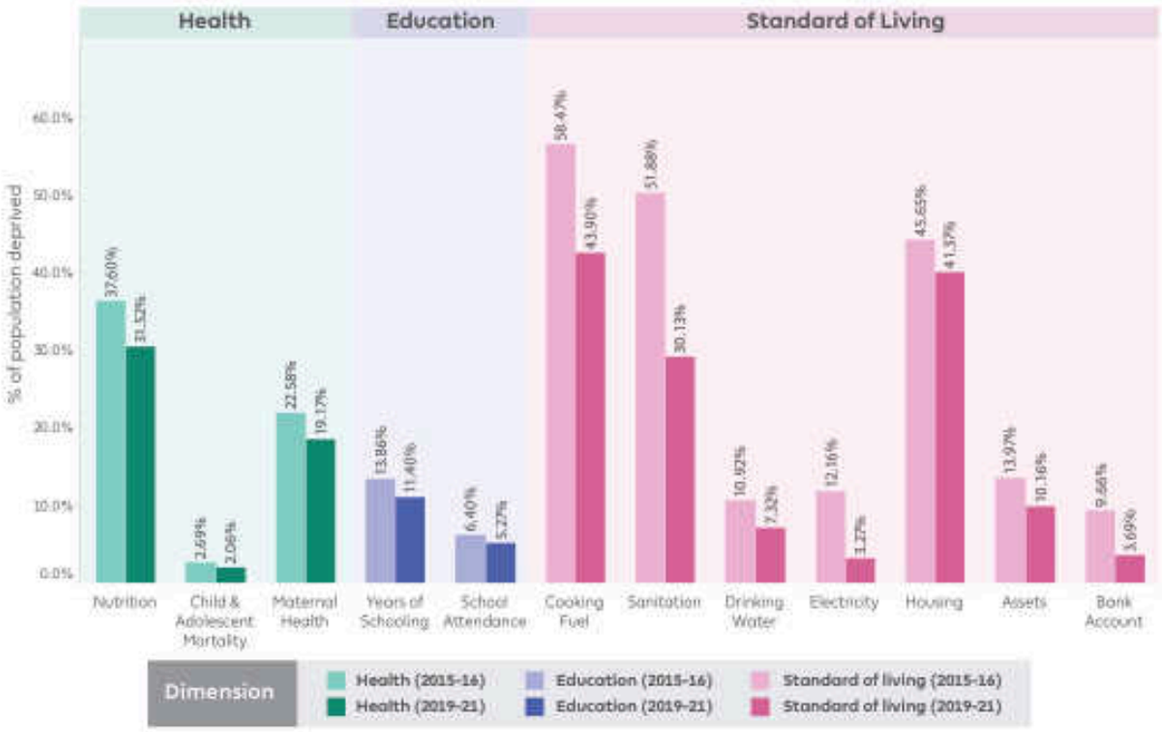
MPI based on NFHS-5 (2019-21)



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Indicator-wise Comparison of Deprivations

The following graph illustrates the percentage of India's population deprived in an indicator. All the 12 indicators across the three dimensions – Health, Education and Standard of living – saw statistically significant reduction across the two time periods. Deprivations in sanitation (reduction by 21.8 % points) and cooking fuel (reduction by 14.6 % points) fell the most during the period from 2015-16 to 2019-21. Overall, progress in nutrition, years of schooling, sanitation, and cooking fuel has been the significant contributor to the decline in MPI value though there is further scope to make improvements.



Conclusion

India's National MPI Report underlines the Government's commitment to understanding, measuring, and addressing the many dimensions of poverty and leveraging this understanding as a key tool in policymaking. The baseline report of the national MPI has been pivotal in raising awareness among state governments, academia, civil society, and citizens about the significance of using multidimensional poverty measures as both a potent policy instrument as well as a mechanism to measure progress. Consequent to the release of the baseline report of National MPI, several MPICC meetings were convened for preparation of Reform Action Plans. Taking into account their priorities and development challenges, various Ministries/Departments have prepared action plans. More than 50 reform actions have been identified in 16 reform areas such as nutrition, financial inclusion, education, rural development, and housing among others. The Ministries in collaboration with States have started implementing these reforms.

India's stellar progress on the national MPI between 2015-16 and 2019-21 reflects the Government's commitment to improving the quality of people's lives – through targeted policies, schemes, and developmental programmes rolled out at both the national and sub-national levels. The Government's focus on investments in critical areas of education, nutrition, water, sanitation, cooking fuel, electricity, and housing has played a pivotal role in driving these positive outcomes. Key Government schemes such as Swachch Bharat Mission (SBM), Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM), Poshan Abhiyan, Samagra Shiksha, Pradhan Mantri Sahaj Bijli Har Ghar Yojana (Saubhagya), Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana (PMUY), Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY), Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (PMAY) and many more have contributed significantly in driving the tremendous progress presented in this report.

The findings from the second edition of the National MPI will serve as a valuable resource for States and Union Territories to identify and amplify actions that have triggered progress since the findings of the Baseline Report, right upto the district level. It will also enable them to track the progress of the vulnerable hotspots and pinpoint areas that require further targeted policy interventions and programmatic action. NITI Aayog, along with other line Ministries, is committed to providing continuous support to the States in formulating and implementing effective reform action plans.

covering 13 SDGs and 39 targets due to issues of data paucity, dated data and indicators that partially explained the targets. Nevertheless, the index offered insights into India's baseline performance in achieving the SDGs while also highlighting the data gaps across sectors and geographies. Despite the limitations, the index was successful in initiating policy dialogues around the SDGs and opened up new arenas of partnership between the Government, private sector, CSOs, development partners and academia.

Following extensive deliberations, peer-reviews, Ministerial and State consultations, the second edition of the SDG India Index, for the year 2019-2020, was an improvement over the earlier version. It was constructed using 100 indicators, covered 54 targets covering all the 17 goals. Goal 17 primarily focuses on partnerships (where sub-national indicators are not available). The indicators chosen were more robust and aligned with Global Goals, targets and the NIF. This version also addressed many of the concerns that were previously raised.

The subsequent editions of the Index have further cemented the partnership between all stakeholders through regular dialogues, workshops and outreach programmes. The third edition of the SDG India Index for 2020-2021 focused on "Partnerships in the Decade of Action" as its theme. It covered 115 indicators and 70 targets.

The fourth edition of the SDG India Index (2023-24), released after a gap since the previous version encompasses 16 goals, 70 targets and 113 indicators. This edition represents a substantial enhancement, meticulously refined through extensive nationwide consultations. These consultations were pivotal in optimising indicator selection in collaboration with States, UTs and Central Ministries through rigorous internal deliberations within NITI Aayog over the past 3 years. The suggestions received from these engagements have led to an enhanced understanding of indicator definitions, data procurement issues, State-specific challenges as well as correction of administrative data and use of survey data. It has triggered a dialogue focused on policy and pegged performance to globally recognizable metrics. Furthermore, this facilitates State departments to have improved convergence with the Centre by encouraging States to provide data to Union Ministries for index estimations and consequently enhance their statistical capacity.

Thus, it can be seen that the review of the indicators and data compilation is carried out by NITI Aayog every year in coordination with MoSPI and relevant Line Ministries. Appropriate feedback is considered in the computation of the index. As a result, every edition is more refined, robust and improved than the previous, in terms of coverage of SDG targets, higher frequency of data, and quality and coverage of indicators. This limits strict comparability between the four editions of the index.





BASELINE REPORT 2018	V2.0 REPORT 2019-20	V3.0 REPORT 2020-21	V4.0 REPORT 2023-24
13 Goals	16 Goals + Qualitative Analysis on Goal 17	16 Goals + Qualitative Analysis on Goal 17	16 Goals + Qualitative Analysis on Goal 17
39 Targets	**54** Targets	**70** Targets	**70** Targets
62 Indicators	**100** Indicators	**115** Indicators	**113** Indicators

From National to Regional to Local

The SDG India Index has been receiving wide recognition since its first edition and has successfully driven the SDG initiatives in the country. NITI Aayog has taken localisation efforts a step further by facilitating SDG localisation at the sub-national level, namely State, district and local levels. As part of these efforts, NITI Aayog has:

- Undertaken extensive sensitisation and capacity-building initiatives on SDGs across States and UTs;
- Advised sub-national Governments on setting up institutional mechanisms at the State level and providing handholding support in ensuring institutional ownership of the 2030 Agenda at the State and UT levels;
- Encouraged the preparation of SIF and DIFs;
- Advised on instituting and operationalising SDG monitoring systems at the State level and
- Encouraged peer learning across States and sub-State levels.

The localisation efforts have enabled various arms of the Government to implement the SDGs in an integrated manner.

North Eastern Region (NER) District SDG Index and Dashboard

The North-Eastern States, which comprise 8 of the 28 States, share a unique historical and geographical context. Despite their cultural and socio-economic diversity, there is wide inter-state and intra-state disparity in the region in terms of development. While some of the States fare well on the NITI Aayog's SDG India Index, challenges persist across the region. Owing to the wide intra-state disparity, districts are emerging as the focus for intensive interventions. This necessitates the availability of reliable data at the district level on nationally recognised indicators. However, the availability of reliable and comparable data at the district level is a considerable challenge. This is more so in the north-eastern region of India, for which data at the State level is also not available for some of the key indicators.

In view of this, NITI Aayog in partnership with the Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region (MDoNER), State Governments and UNDP has developed an SDG Index for the north-eastern region at the district level. The NER District SDG Index is the first of its kind index in the country as the metrics and methodology are customised for the region and progress is measured at the district level. The Index compares 129 districts from the 8 north-eastern States across all sectors of the SDGs. The index has been computed using 84 indicators, covering 14 Goals and 50 SDG targets. It will not only serve as a tool for fast-tracking the progress of SDGs in the region but will enhance analytical understanding on sectoral issues as well as data gaps.

All aspects related to the selection of indicators and computation methodology of the NER District SDG Index and Dashboard followed extensive consultation with all the 8 States of the region. States played a crucial role in shaping the index by enriching the feedback process with localised insights and field experience. The methodology for estimating the index is the same as that used for the SDG India Index while indicators have been selected from the NIF, SDG India Index, and the SIF prepared by the respective north-eastern States after extensive consultations.

An interactive dashboard was also prepared to allow users to explore and visualise the data in the NER District SDG Index Report. The dashboard allows for region-level and district-level insights and is a powerful tool for extracting critical insights from the NER District SDG Index data. The performance of the District SDG Index will provide States with opportunities for peer learning, policy tweaking, mid-course correction and resource allocation at the district level. It will further enable other States to develop similar composite indices to close the district-wise disparities and overcome statistical challenges.

SDG Urban Index and Dashboard

Taking the SDG monitoring to the level of cities, NITI Aayog has developed an SDG Index for urban centres in India, using a framework of 77 indicators and measuring the performance of 56 Indian cities. The cities were ranked as per their performance and achievements across sectors pertaining to poverty reduction, health and nutrition, gender equality and inequality, infrastructure, urban facilities, resource efficiency, climate action and governance at the city level. This has facilitated the need for urban-centric SDG action on one hand and emphasised on improving city-level data and statistical ecosystems on the other hand. This is yet another milestone achieved by NITI Aayog in building its institutional capacity to design and develop robust SDG progress monitoring systems at the local level.

Impact of the Index and Dashboard in Furthering 2030 Agenda

The SDG India Index, since its inaugural launch in 2018, has been comprehensively documenting and ranking the progress made by States and UTs towards achieving the SDGs. It has had a significant impact in shaping the development discourse around 2030 Agenda and triggering action.

- The composite index score and rank has emerged as an advocacy tool for States/UTs to initiate the discussion around SDGs and the challenges pertaining to achieving them since it is simple and easy to interpret and communicate.
- The considerable recognition garnered by the indices at both the national and regional levels has led to Government and public engagement in critical issues that affect people's lives. It has generated active discussion among all relevant stakeholders on the progress made on SDGs, challenges encountered, possible redressal strategies and quality of data. The index has opened up new vistas of partnership between the Government, academia and CSOs, raised awareness about SDGs, and has firmly placed SDGs in policy dialogues.
- The SDG index has triggered healthy competition among States and UTs on SDGs. They have enabled States to benchmark their progress relative to others and identify priority areas, thereby promoting competition to improve performance.
- The index has emerged as a powerful tool for data-driven decision-making, which offers excellent possibilities for States and UTs to identify priority areas requiring improvements, better targeting and effective resource allocation.

- The index reports have given impetus to States and UTs to deepen SDG localisation at district and local levels. It has initiated monitoring at district levels, thereby promoting healthy competition among districts.

- The preparation of the report and indices has revealed crucial data gaps at the national, State, UT and district levels for SDG monitoring. It has brought to focus the need to improve the statistical system and the national and sub-national levels using innovative methods.

- This index has dismantled silos between economic, social and environmental metrics of measurement and provides a complete and summary overview of progress.

- It has also prompted the planning departments across the States to adopt a more holistic approach to measure progress at the State level and helped in highlighting the gaps in data across goals.

- At a conceptual level, it has sparked crucial dialogues on the inclusivity of the indicator set and its value to vulnerable people.

The imperfections of the Index were recognised even when it was first launched. However, it was developed as an essential tool for communicating the new framework, capable of drawing attention to the indivisibility of the economic, social and environmental pillars when assessing a country's progress. However, one needs to be cautious with numeric indicators – any index does not and cannot represent the richness and the nuances of the framework or concept it attempts to measure. It is only a tool to track progress over a period on defined indicators.

In 1990, the UNDP Human Development Index famously dethroned the GDP as the ultimate measure of progress and spurred a new global discourse of what constitutes development. In this case, the SDG India Index, despite its "statistical" limitations, has been catalytic in generating awareness about global goals, especially among the political leadership in the country.

The latest SDG India Index 2023-24, computation is based on 113 indicators across 70 targets of 16 goals and uses the latest available data from Government officials, ministries and the States. It is important to note that this version of the Index is not strictly comparable with other previous versions. This challenge is due to revision of indicator set to benefit from the most recent data. A qualitative analysis of SDG 17 is also presented in chapter 4 of this report.

It is hoped that this version will not only provide an overview of the progress but also help policymakers to undertake comparative analysis of their achievements vis-à-vis other States and UTs. It is also worth reiterating that the achievements of Indian States and UTs will help the global community to progress towards the SDGs and this Index will serve as a crucial resource for all stakeholders.

SDG India Index Methodology

The methodology of SDG India Index was developed in 2019 in close association with the MoSPI; with the Data and Methodology Committee chaired by MoSPI, leading the efforts; and is primarily based on the methodology used by the Sustainable Development Solutions Network (SDSN), a global initiative under the auspices of the UNSG. The Committee had members from NITI Aayog, MoSPI, UN agencies and key ministries. The Committee took the leadership role in – examining various methodologies and arriving at the most suitable one, development of the Index, identification of indicators and determining data gaps. The constitution, work and contribution of the Committee stand out as an example of convergence – multiple stakeholders coming together to address a common challenge.



1. Selection of indicators

The first step in constructing the index was identifying suitable indicators. The NIF was consulted to ensure alignment with national development priorities, and relevant indicators were identified and mapped with the targets. The previous edition of the Index and the NIF, put together by MoSPI, served as the basis for selecting these indicators. NITI Aayog had constructed a list of select indicators, refining them with all stakeholders' feedback to aid comparison. Further, extensive consultations and workshops with concerned Union ministries/ departments and all States/UTs led to finalising a framework of 113 indicators. To determine suitable metrics for inclusion in the Index, technically sound and quantitative criteria-based indicators were chosen that had:

i. Relevance to the SDG global targets;

ii. Alignment with the NIF;

iii. Data availability at the national level for States and UTs from official statistical systems;

iv. The consent of respective Ministries/ Departments;

v. Data ownership, either administrative or survey, by Line Ministries, and

vi. Sufficient data coverage, such that data for at least 80 percent of the States/UTs is available.

While most of the indicators used to estimate the composite index are taken directly from the NIF, some of these indicators have been modified in view of the evolving availability of data across all the States and UTs. Where State/UT-level data was unavailable for NIF indicators, suitable proxy indicators were identified from official data sources. The NIF indicators for which data was unavailable at the State/UT level could not be included.

2. Consultation with stakeholders

The latest data on the selected indicators was collected with the respective ministries and MoSPI. Several rounds of consultations with the ministries were organised to arrive at suitable proxy indicators. The indicator refining and selection were preceded by intensive rounds of consultations with the primary stakeholders, namely the States/UTs. The draft list of indicators was circulated to all States/UTs, and comments were received from them. Detailed workshops were conducted in several States, with Chief Secretaries and concerned senior officials, including Planning Secretaries and Heads of Departments to elicit indicator-wise feedback on the appropriateness, robustness and data challenges.

3. Summary of indicators

In the SDG India Index 2023-24, out of the 113 indicators, 90 are common to the previous version for the year 2020-21. Updated values have been used for 104 indicators as compared to the SDG India Index 2020-21. Out of the 113 reported indicators, 107 were used for the Index estimation. Five indicators under Goal 14 were excluded as they pertain solely to the 9 coastal States, while one indicator in Goal 10 was not used due to lack of comparability. In cases where data was unavailable for all States/UTs, the missing cells were marked as "Null" and were not assigned any weightage in Index estimation.

Among the 113 indicators, 100 are directly aligned with NIF 2024 (75 precisely from NIF and 25 similar to NIF indicators), while the remaining 13 are derived in consultation with States/UTs and Line Ministries.

4. Target setting

After the final aggregation of the raw data, a process of target setting was undertaken. A suitable target value for 2030 was set for each indicator. The targets set by the UN at the global level were adopted with respect to 80 indicators, for instance, the target of reducing Maternal Mortality Ratio (MMR) to 70 per 100,000 live births by 2030. For 24 indicators, targets set by Government of India were used. Benchmarks set by international development organisations or international standards were adopted for 5 indicators, including the World Health Organisation (WHO) target of 50 percent reduction of anaemia in women of reproductive age by 2025. For indicators with no specified quantitative target, the target has been set by deriving an average of top 3 States from the base year. For 3 out of 5 indicators under Goal 14, it is to be noted that

the ideal value that can be set as a target is not fixed but falls within a range and for 1 indicator under Goal 10, target has not been assigned due to lack of comparability.

5. Normalisation of raw indicator values

The following step was normalisation of raw indicator values to arrive at normalised scores. The normalisation of indicator values to a standard scale of 0 to 100 was required to ensure comparability as different indicators had different ranges of values and units. For instance, while MMR is per 100,000 live births, headcount ratio is measured as a percentage. In the normalised range of 0 to 100, 0 indicates lowest performance and 100 implies that the target has been achieved.

For indicators where higher value means better performance, for example, the proportion of institutional deliveries, the following formula was used:

$$x' = \frac{x - min(x)}{T(x) - min(x)} \times 100$$

Where, x = raw data value
min(x) = minimum observed value of the indicator in the dataset
T(x) = target value for the indicator
x' = normalised value after rescaling

For indicators where higher value implies lower performance, for instance, Infant Mortality Rate, the following formula was used:

$$x' = \left[1 - \frac{x - T(x)}{max(x) - T(x)}\right] \times 100$$

Where, x = raw data value
max(x) = maximum observed value of the indicator in the dataset
T(x) = target value for the indicator
x' = normalised value after rescaling

Where the States/UTs had achieved beyond the target set, the normalised score was capped at 100.

Target values for indicators under goal 14 were not used to compute normalised score as for most of them the ideal value is not fixed but falls within a range.

Raw data under this goal was therefore normalised as following:

$$x' = \frac{x - min(x)}{max(x) - min(x)} \times 100$$

Where, x = raw data value
min(x) = minimum observed value of the indicator in the dataset
max(x) = maximum observed value of the indicator in the dataset
x' = normalised value after rescaling

6. Computation of State/UT scores

Computation of State/UT-wise score for each goal followed normalisation. This was estimated as the arithmetic mean of the normalised values of all indicators under the goal, for each State/UT. Equal weight was assigned to each indicator.

$$I_{ij}(N_{ij}, I_{ijk}) = \sum_{k=1}^{N_{ij}} \frac{1}{N_{ij}} I_{ijk}$$

Where Iij = Goal score for State/UT i under SDG j
Nij = number of non-null indicators for State/UT i under SDG j
Iijk = normalised value for State/UT i of indicator k under SDG j

The Goal score Iij for State/UT i under Goal j was then computed. Based on the Goal score, the States/UT were classified into four categories under each Goal.

Achiever: when the Index score equals 100;

Front Runner: when the Index score is between 65 and 99;

Performer: when the Index score is between 50 and 64;

Aspirant: when the Index score is less than 50.

7. Computation of Composite Index Scores

The next step was the computation of composite Index score for every State/UT. The composite score is the arithmetic mean of the Goal score for 16 Goals, for each State/UT, assigning equal

weight to each Goal. This score is an indication of the overall position of the State/UTs in their journey towards achieving the SDGs. The State/UTs were again classified into the four categories based on their composite score.

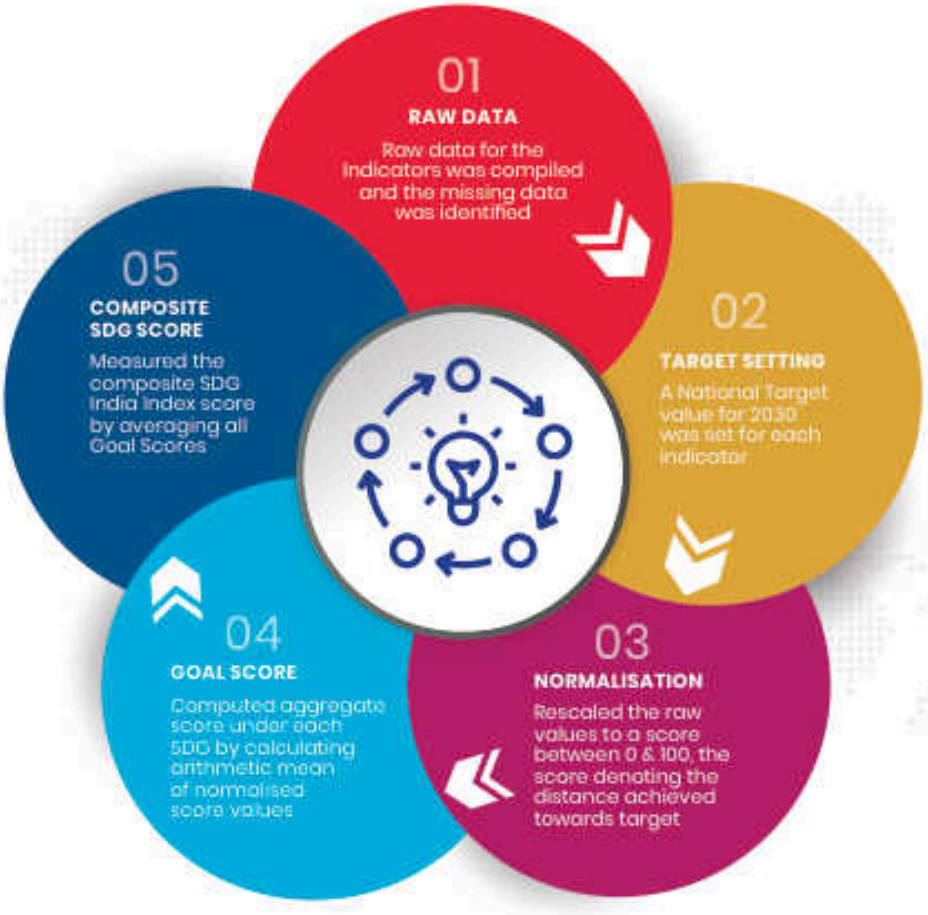
$$I_i(N_i,N_{ij},I_{ijk}) = \frac{1}{N_i}\sum_{j=1}^{N_i} I_{ij}(N_{ij},I_{ijk})$$

Where Ii = composite SDG index score of State/UTs i
Ni = number of Goal scores for which State/UTs i has non-null data
Iij = goal score for State/UTs i under SDG j
Iijk = normalised value for State/UTs i of indicator k under SDG j

8. Categorisation of State/UTs

Given the reach of SDGs across a multitude of social, political and economic spheres of life as well as the depth of each goal through the numerous varying targets and the complex inter-relation and interdependencies between each goal, it is an extremely complicated task to set up scientific classes of performance for each goal and to tie them together. Hence, a clean and simple mechanism of classification was adopted. This was based on the score of each State across all 16 SDGs. The States were classified into the 4 categories based on their distance from target. This was done such that any State with a score of 100 would be called an Achiever since the State would have achieved all the targets outlined by the SDGs. Any State with 65 or more progress would be classified as a Front Runner as the States are nearing the target versus the others. States above 50 are Performers. States that are yet to achieve even 50 of the distance to target are classified as Aspirants. When looking at the distribution of the States in terms of the aggregate SDG score across the 4 classifications, one can observe that no State is a 100 on all 16 goals. While 24 out of the 28 States are in the Front Runner category and 4 States in the Performer category, among the UTs all 8 are in Front Runner category.

METHODOLOGY OF CONSTRUCTION OF THE INDEX



Reading the Index 2023-24

Some of the key issues, which are pertinent to take into cognizance while reading the Index 2023-24, are as follows:

1. The data sources for the selected indicators have been limited to national survey reports of Union ministries, national data portals of Union ministries, MIS portals of Centrally-Sponsored Schemes/Central Sector Schemes, and in some specific cases, the index reports prepared by Union ministries. The concern raised by several States, in this regard, has been the inability of this Index to take cognizance of the data provided individually by States. It must be noted here that in the interest of uniformity of methodology of data collection – statistical methods, sampling methods, definitional issues, computational uniformity issues, etc., it was considered prudent to rely on single official source of data for any given indicator, which provides values for most if not all the States and UTs, to avoid discrepancies, confusion and possible error.

2. Some States have also voiced concerns that in capturing the progress of several schemes, largely CSS, mapped to the SDG targets, the schemes which are entirely financed and implemented by State Governments are often overlooked in measuring progress. A common example is the coverage of medical insurance and housing, where several States implement their own State schemes in addition to the CSS – Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana and Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana, respectively. SDG Index 2023-24 has tried to address this concern by increasingly shifting to outcome indicators, sourced from national survey reports, to replace scheme-specific indicators, on the premise that outcome indicators, such as "percentage of households with at least one member covered by health insurance" or "percentage of households living in kachha houses" will bring out ground realities in a far more comprehensive way and will be a function of the efficacy of both Central and State-run schemes. The indicators used in SDG Index 2023-24 are a mix of outcome and scheme indicators, with only 16 out of the 113 indicators being scheme-based indicators. The aim is to shift completely towards outcome indicators in subsequent editions. Moreover, State schemes also offer a large amount of variance across States, and raise challenges of uniformity, which cannot be overlooked in this exercise to compare all the States/UTs.

3. Limitations pertaining to the frequency of data sources continue to exist, largely due to the issues of disaggregation, granularity and periodicity of data collected by the official statistical systems. Some of the latest national-level survey reports could not be utilised as they cover only a limited number of States. Using such reports, which are the latest in periodicity but do not cover all States/UTs, would create statistical lacunae since a large number of States would be left with a "Null" value, thereby challenging the robustness of the method. Nevertheless, latest values have been used for all indicators, from the most recent data sources. For administrative data sourced from Central Ministries, the cut-off ranges from FY 2022–2023 to FY 2023–2024, depending upon availability for all 36 sub-national entities. More than 80 percent of the indicators have data sourced from the last 3 years (25 belong to the 2023–2024 period, 32 from 2022–2023 and 24 belong to 2022–2021). The rest 20 percent indicators have data sourced from 2015–2016 to 2020–2021. For some indicators, where the data is not available for some States or some UTs, 'null' value has been ascribed.

4. With consistent efforts by the Government of India, some scheme-based indicators have nearly reached saturation. Consequently, all States/UTs have scored above 90 percent in these indicators. The indicators include: (i) Persons offered employment as a percentage of persons who demanded employment under MGNREGA, (ii) Percentage of rural population having an improved source of drinking water, (iii) Percentage of households with any usual member having a bank or post office account, and (iv) Percentage of targeted habitations connected by all-weather roads under PMGSY. It was observed that due to the nature of the methodology, States/UTs received lower scores in these indicators, despite achieving high performance. Therefore, for such indicators, the minimum score has been fixed, making the score equal to the raw value.

5. Methodological issue of using arithmetic mean over geometric mean and equal weights: The Index 2023-24 methodology is based on the

SDSN Global SDG Index, where the case for using arithmetic mean over geometric mean has been detailed. In brief, geometric mean is often used to aggregate heterogeneous variables with limited substitutability and in cases where the focus of the analysis is on percentage changes instead of absolute changes. To aggregate indicator scores within each SDG, arithmetic mean was used ("weak substitutability") because each SDG describes a set of broadly complementary policy priorities – though there are a few exceptions. This implies that States/UTs are indifferent to adding a unit of progress on any of the indicators comprised under a goal. Further, each goal and indicators thereof had equal weights, since the 17 Goals are integral and indivisible to the 2030 Agenda. An Index score between 0 and 100 reflects the average initial placement of the State/UT between the worst and the best on an average of the goals. Based on the similarity of results and the greater ease of interpretation, arithmetic mean was opted.

6. Goal 14 (Life Below Water) primarily applies to a limited number of coastal States/UTs. Consequently, this goal has not been included in the calculation of the Composite Score for the Index.

Periodicity of Indicators

GOAL	2015-2016	2016-2017	2016-2020	2017-2018	2018-2019	2018-2020	2019-2020	2019-2021	2020-2021	2021-2022	2022-2023	2023-2024	Grand Total
SDG 1								3				2	5
SDG 2								4		1	1	1	7
SDG 3			1	1		2	1				4	2	11
SDG 4					1					10	1		12
SDG 5	1							5			2	1	9
SDG 6										3	2	2	7
SDG 7										1		1	2
SDG 8								1			5	2	8
SDG 9								1		1	4	2	8
SDG 10								1	1	1	3		6
SDG 11								1	1		1	4	7
SDG 12									1	2	1	1	5
SDG 13		1			1		1				1	1	5
SDG 14										1		4	5
SDG 15	1				1					4	1		7
SDG 16								1			6	2	9
Grand Total	2	1	1	1	3	2	2	17	3	24	32	25	113

Limitations of the Index

While Index 2023-24 is a useful instrument to measure and encapsulate the progress of the States/UTs in adopting and implementing the SDG agenda, the Index and this report have the following limitations.

1. The Index does not measure indicators of SDG 17 owing to the unavailability of suitable data at the State/UT level. However, a qualitative assessment of the progress under SDG 17 has been included.

2. The full set of the NIF could not be included, due to the unavailability of data at the State/UT level, and in the interest of sharper focus.

3. Indicators without specified quantitative targets have their targets set based on the average of the top three States from the base value, rather than from the current year. This approach ensures consistency in target values over time, avoiding frequent adjustments and maintaining stability in goal setting.

4. The indicators and data from State/UT statistical systems and non-government sources have not been included to ensure data comparability and uniformity across them.

5. While assigning unequal weights to some indicators might have suited some States/UTs owing to their local context, this has not been followed given the normative assumption that all SDGs are equally significant.

6. For some indicators, data for all States/UTs are not available. In computing the Index, "Null" has been assigned to these States/UTs and they have not been included in the computation. This does not necessarily imply any negative implication.

7. While the latest values of the indicators have been used, most of them are taken between 2021-2022 and 2023-2024, which implies recent periodicity but not uniform periodicity across all goals.

8. Alignment of SDG India Index 2023-24 indicators with NIF has been ensured to the maximum extent possible and these are slightly different from SDG India Index 2018, 2019-2020 and 2020-2021, in view of the constant refinement and improvements being attempted with the rich body of feedback and suggestions from our primary stakeholders (i.e., the States and the UTs). The indicator set for SDG India Index 2023-2024 and 2020-2021 are strictly not comparable.

The Index has played a key role in accelerating 2030 Agenda in the States and UTs of India. The results of the ranking are always highly publicised through the national and regional media. It has raised awareness on SDGs at many levels – within Government, media, researchers and CSOs. In many States/UTs, post the release of the Index report, SDG reviews were initiated. Some Governments instituted high-level committees to oversee SDG adoption. The Index also pushed SDG localisation in almost all States/UTs to the next level where district-level monitoring was initiated, thereby promoting healthy competition among the districts on the SDGs.



GOAL-WISE
TOP STATES/UTs

Goal 16: Peace, Justice and Strong Institutions
Gujarat | Ladakh

Goal 15: Life on Land
Jharkhand | Tripura | Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu

Goal 14: Life Below Water
West Bengal

Goal 13: Climate Action
Sikkim | Tamil Nadu | Chandigarh

Goal 12: Responsible Consumption and Production
Tripura | Jammu & Kashmir

Goal 11: Sustainable Cities and Communities
Maharashtra | Chandigarh

Goal 10: Reduced Inequality
Goa | Puducherry

Goal 9: Industry, Innovation and Infrastructure
Goa | Puducherry





Goal 1: No Poverty

Tamil Nadu | Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu

Goal 2: Zero Hunger

Kerala | Puducherry

Goal 3: Good Health and Well-being

Gujarat | Delhi

Goal 4: Quality Education

Kerala | Delhi

Goal 5: Gender Equality

Nagaland | Lakshadweep

Goal 6: Clean Water and Sanitation

Goa | Andaman and Nicobar Islands

Goal 7: Affordable and Clean Energy

Andhra Pradesh
Assam
Goa
Haryana
Himachal Pradesh
Karnataka
Kerala
Maharashtra
Mizoram
Punjab
Rajasthan
Tamil Nadu
Telangana
Uttarakhand
Uttar Pradesh
West Bengal
Andaman and Nicobar Islands
Chandigarh
Delhi
Jammu and Kashmir
Ladakh
Puducherry

Goal 8: Decent Work and Economic Growth

Himachal Pradesh | Ladakh

INDIA RESULTS

Composite SDG India Index 2023-24

The composite score for each State/UT was computed by aggregating their performance across the goals, by taking the arithmetic mean of individual goal scores. The composite score ranges from 0 to 100 and denotes the overall achievement of the State/UT in achieving the targets under the Goals. A score of 100 implies that the State/UT has achieved the targets set for 2030; a score of 0 implies that the particular State/UT is at the bottom of the table.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

At National Level

- The composite score for India improved from 66 in 2020-21 to 71 in 2023-24. This indicates that the country has accelerated progress on the SDGs despite global headwinds.
- Between 2020-21 and 2023-24, significant progress observed in Goals 1 (No Poverty), 8 (Decent Work and Economic Growth) and 13 (Climate Action) and these goals are now in front runner category. Goal 13 records highest increase in score from 54 to 67 followed by Goal 1 from 60 to 72.
- Significant affirmative developments since 2018 in Goals 1 (No Poverty), 3 (Good Health and Well-being), 6 (Clean Water and Sanitation), 7 (Affordable and Clean energy) and 11 (Sustainable Cities and Communities).
- Eleven Goals drive the positive push - Goals 1 (No Poverty), 3 (Good Health and Well-being), 6 (Clean Water and Sanitation), 7 (Affordable and Clean Energy), 8 (Decent Work and Economic Growth), 10 (Reduce Inequalities), 11 (Sustainable Cities and Communities), 12 (Responsible Consumption and Production), 13 (Climate Action), 15 (Life on Land), and 16 (Peace, Justice, and Strong Institutions), where India has scored between 65 and 99.
- In three Goals - 2 (Zero Hunger), 4 (Quality Education) and 9 (Industry, Innovation and Infrastructure), the overall score lies between 50 and 64, indicating opportunity for improvement in the coming years.
- Goal 5 (Gender Equality) demands special attention, as the overall country score is below 50. Goal 5 has 14 States and UTs in Aspirant category.
- Government's focus on ensuring food & nutrition security, health, education, electrification, housing for all, sanitation, clean cooking fuel & energy has significantly contributed to the improvements.

At State/ UT levels

- The SDG India Index 2023-24 scores for States range from 57 to 79, while for UTs they range between 65 and 77. This marks an improvement over the 2020-21 scores, where States ranged from 52 to 75, and UTs ranged from 62 to 79.
- Uttarakhand and Kerala lead as top States with scores of 79 each; Chandigarh maintains top spot among UTs with a score of 77.
- Tamil Nadu took the third spot followed by Goa and Himachal Pradesh.
- Top Gainer States between 2018 and 2023-24 include Uttar Pradesh (increase in score by 25), followed by Jammu and Kashmir (21), Uttarakhand (19), Sikkim (18), Haryana (17), Assam, Punjab and Tripura (16 each), Madhya Pradesh and Odisha (15 each).
- In 2023-24, 32 States/UTs are in Front Runner Category (Scores 65-99), up from 22 States/ UTs in 2020-21. 10 new entrants to the category of Front Runners include Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh, Manipur, Odisha, Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh, West Bengal and Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu.

Highlights

Forest and tree cover: The national target for India is 33 percent of the geographical area under the forest and tree cover set by the National Afforestation and Eco-Development Board. Forest area refers to all lands more than one hectare in area, having a tree canopy density of more than 10 percent. Tree area is an estimated area comprising of tree patches of less than one hectare of area. According to the Forest Survey of India 2021, 21.71 percent of the geographical area is under the forest cover and 2.91 percent is under tree cover bringing around 25 percent of the total geographical area under forest and tree cover. However, 14 States and 5 UTs have achieved the national target. Mizoram has the maximum geographical area under forest cover with 84.53 percent among the States. Haryana, Punjab and Rajasthan have less than 5.0 percent of forest cover. Among the UTs, 90.33 percent of Lakshadweep is under forest area, which is the highest among all States/UTs. The area under tree cover is maximum in Chandigarh with 13.16 percent followed by Delhi with 9.91 percent among the UTs. Kerala has 7.26 percent of tree cover which is the highest among the States while Sikkim has the least tree cover at 0.55 percent.

Area covered under afforestation schemes: According to EnviStats 2023, almost 13,26,963 hectares of the geographical area is covered under different afforestation schemes in the country which amounts to 0.4 percent of total geographical area. Uttarakhand has the maximum area under afforestation with 4.16 percent among all the States, followed by Telangana with 2.63 percent. Puducherry has 2.75 percent of area under afforestation which is the highest among the UTs.

Carbon stock in forest cover: The amount of carbon captured from the atmosphere and stored in the forests is considered as carbon stock. It reduces the greenhouse gases in the environment. According to Forest Survey of India 2021, around 1.11 percent of change is observed in the carbon stock in forest-covered areas in 2021. Telangana with 6.68 percent has the highest percentage increase in carbon stock followed by West Bengal with 5.12 percent. In 10 States and 5 UTs, the carbon stock has decreased in 2021. Among the UTs, carbon stock in Lakshadweep has reduced the most at -11.02 percent.

Land degradation: In 2015-2016, around 27.77 percent of the total land area was degraded as reported by the National Remote Sensing Centre. Punjab has the lowest percentage of land degraded at 3.15 percent followed by West Bengal at 5.56 percent while Rajasthan has the highest at 52.69 percent. Among the UTs, Chandigarh has the least with 0.50 percent degraded land of the total land area.

Desertification: In 2018-2019, around 1.5 percent of the area has increased under desertification in the country as per the Desertification and Land Degradation Atlas of India. Only in three States, namely Rajasthan with (-1.34) percent reduction, followed by Jharkhand (-0.3 percent), and Gujarat (-0.13 percent), showed a decreasing trend in the desertified area. Mizoram had the highest percentage increase in desertification with 47.14 percent. Among the UTs, Jammu and Kashmir saw the highest increase of 6.08 percent in desertification.

Wildlife crime cases: 16 wildlife crime cases per million hectares of protected area under Wildlife Protection Act (1972) were reported in 2023. Crime against wildlife was reported the most in Goa (355), Punjab (131), Uttarakhand (104) and West Bengal (99).

MINISTRY OF ENVIRONMENT & FORESTS

The Noise Pollution (Regulation and Control) Rules, 2000;

(As amended till 10/08/2017 vide S.O. 2555(E))

S.O.123 (E).- Whereas the increasing ambient noise levels in public places from various sources, inter-alia, industrial activity, construction activity, *(fire crackers, sound producing instruments)*[1], generator sets, loud speakers, public address systems, music systems, vehicular horns and other mechanical devices have deleterious effects on human health and the psychological well being of the people, it is considered necessary to regulate and control noise producing and generating sources with the objective of maintaining the ambient air quality standards in respect of noise;

Whereas a draft of Noise Pollution (Control and Regulation) Rules, 1999 was published under the notification of the Government of India in the Ministry of Environment and Forests vide number S.O. 528 (E) dated the 28th June, 1999 inviting objections and suggestions from all the persons likely to be affected thereby, before the expiry of the period of sixty days from the date on which the copies of the Gazette containing the said notification are made available to the public-,

And whereas copies of the said Gazette were made available to the public on the 1st day of July, 1999,

And whereas the objections and suggestions received from the public in respect of the said draft rules have been duly considered by the Central Government-,

Now therefore, In exercise of the powers conferred by clause (ii) of sub-section (2) of section 3, sub-section (1) and clause (b) of sub-section (2) of section 6 and section 25 of the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986 (29 of 1986) read with rule 5 of the Environment (Protection) Rules, 1986, the Central Government hereby makes the following rules for the regulation and control of noise producing and generating sources, namely:

The Noise Pollution (Regulation and Control) Rules, 2000

1. Short title and commencement.

(1) These rules may be called the Noise Pollution (Regulation and Control) Rules, 2000.

(2) They shall come into force on the date of their publication in the Official Gazette.

2. Definitions.- In these rules, unless the context otherwise requires,

(a) "Act" means the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986 (29 of 1986);

(b) "area/zone" means all areas which fall in either of the four categories given in the Schedule annexed to these rules;

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1. In the said rules, in the opening para/portion after the words 'construction activity" additional words as at **(1)** above have been inserted vide **S.O.50 dated 11/01/2010**.

[(c) "authority" means and includes any authority or officer authorised by the Central Government, or as the case may be, the State Government in accordance with the laws in force and includes a District Magistrate, Police Commissioner, or any other officer not below the rank of the Deputy Superintendent of Police designated for the maintenance of the ambient air quality standards in respect of noise under any law for the time being in force;][2]

[(d) "court" means a governmental body consisting of one or more judges who sit to adjudicate disputes and administer justice and includes any court of law presided over by a judge, judges or a magistrate and acting as a tribunal in civil, taxation and criminal cases;

(e) "educational institution" means a school, seminary, college, university, professional academies, training institutes or other educational establishment, not necessarily a chartered institution and includes not only buildings, but also all grounds necessary for the accomplishment of the full scope of educational instruction, including those things essential to mental, moral and physical development;

(f) "hospital" means an institution for the reception and care of sick, wounded, infirm or aged persons, and includes government or private hospitals, nursing homes and clinics;][3]

[(g) "person" shall include any company or association or body of individuals, whether incorporated or not;][4]

(h) "State Government" in relation to a Union territory means the Administrator thereof appointed under article 239 of the Constitution.

[(i) *"public place" means any place to which the public have access, whether as of right or not, and includes auditorium, hotels, public waiting rooms, convention centres, public offices, shopping malls, cinema halls, educational institutions, libraries, open grounds and the like which are visited by general public; and*

(j) "night time" means the period between 10.00 p.m. and 6.00 a.m.][6]

3. <u>Ambient air quality standards in respect of noise for different areas/zones.</u>

(1) The ambient air quality standards in respect of noise for different areas/zones shall be such as specified in the Schedule annexed to these rules.

(2) The State Government (shall categorize)[5] the areas into industrial, commercial, residential or silence areas/zones for the purpose of implementation of noise standards for different areas.

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2. In rule 2 for clause "*(c) "authority" means any authority or officer authorized by the Central Government, or as the case may be, the State Government in accordance with the laws in force and includes a District Magistrate, Police Commissioner, or any other officer designated for the maintenance of the ambient air quality standards in respect of noise under any law for the time being in force;*" has been substituted with a new clause as at **(2)** above vide **S.O.1046 (E) dated 22/11/2000.**
3. In rule 2, after Clause (c) new clause (d) (e) & (f) have been inserted as at **(3)** above vide **S.O.1046 dated 22/11/2000.**
4. In rule 2, clause (d) & (e) have been re-numbered as clauses (g) and (h) respectively and for (g) as so renumbered "*(g) "person" in relation to any factory or premises means a person or occupier or his agent, who has control over the affairs of the factory or premises;*" has been substituted as at **(4)** above **vide S.O. 1046 (E) dated 22/11/2000.**
5. In sub-rule (2) of rule 3 of the said rules, for the words "may categorize", the words "shall categorize" has been substituted as at **(5)** above vide **S.O.1046 dated 22/11/2000**
6. In the said rules, in rule 2, after clause (h), the following clauses (i) & (j) have been inserted as at **(6)** above vide **S.O. 50 dated 11/01/2010.**

(3) The State Government shall take measures for abatement of noise including noise emanating from vehicular movements, *(blowing of horns, bursting of sound emitting fire crackers, use of loud speakers or public address system and sound producing instruments)*[9] and ensure that the existing noise levels do not exceed the ambient air quality standards specified under these rules.

(4) All development authorities, local bodies and other concerned authorities while planning developmental activity or carrying out functions relating to town and country planning shall take into consideration all aspects of noise pollution as a parameter of quality of life to avoid noise menace and to achieve the objective of maintaining the ambient air quality standards in respect of noise.

(5) An area comprising not less than 100 metres around hospitals, educational institutions and courts may be declared (by the State Government)[14] as silence area/zone for the purpose of these rules.

{Provided that, an area shall not fall under silence area or zone category, unless notified by the State Government in accordance with sub-rule(2).}[14]

4. Responsibility as to enforcement of noise pollution control measures.

(1) The noise levels in any area/zone shall not exceed the ambient air quality standards in respect of noise as specified in the Schedule.

(2) The authority shall be responsible for the enforcement of noise pollution control measures and the due compliance of the ambient air quality standards in respect of noise.

[(3) The respective State Pollution Control Boards or Pollution Control Committees in consultation with the Central Pollution Control Board shall collect, compile and publish technical and statistical data relating to noise pollution and measures devised for its effective prevention, control and abatement.][8]

5. Restrictions on the use of loud speakers/public address system *(and sound producing instruments)*.[10]

(1) A loud speaker or a public address system shall not be used except after obtaining written permission from the authority.

[(2) A loud speaker or a public address system or any sound producing instrument or a musical instrument or a sound amplifier shall not be used at night time except in closed premises for communication within, like auditoria, conference rooms, community halls or during a public emergency.][11]

[(3) Notwithstanding anything contained in sub-rule (2), the State Government may subject to such terms and conditions as are necessary to reduce noise pollution, permit use of loud speakers or public address systems and the like during night hours (between 10.00 p.m. to 12.00 midnight) on or during any cultural, religious or festive occasion of a limited duration not exceeding fifteen days in all during a calender year and the concerned State Government or District Authority in respect of its jurisdiction as authorized by the concerned State Government shall generally specify in advance, the number and particulars of the days on which such exemption should be operative.

Explanation.- For the purposes of this sub-rule, the expressions-

(i) *"festive occasion" shall include any National function or State function as notified by the Central Government or State Government; and*

(ii) *"National function or State function" shall include"-*

(A) *Republic Day;*
(B) *Independence Day;*
(C) *State Day; or*
(D) *such other day as notified by the Central Government or the State Government.]*[15]

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7. In rule 5 after sub-rule (2) new rule 3 has been inserted as at **(7)** above vide **S.O. 1088 (E) dated 11/10/2002**.
8. In rule 4 after sub-rule (2) new sub-rule (3) has been inserted as at **(8)** above vide **S.O. 1569 (E) dated 19/09/2006**.
9. In the said rules, in rule 3, in sub-rule (3) after the words "noise emanating from vehicular movements, the additional words as at **(9)** above have been inserted vide **S.O. 50 dated 11/01/2010**.
10. In rule 5, for heading after the words "public address system" new words has been inserted as at **(10)** vide **S.O.50 dated 11/01/2010**.
11. In rule 5, sub-rule (2) has been substituted by new sub-rule as at **(11)** above vide **S.O. 50 dated 11/01/2010**.
12. In rule 5, in sub-rule (3) for the words "public address systems during night hours" has been substituted by new words as at **(12)** above vide **S.O. 50 dated 11/01/2010**.
13. In rule 5, in sub-rule (3) after the words "a limited duration……..a calendar year" new sentence has been added as at **(13)** above vide **S.O. 50 dated 11/01/2010**.
14. In rule 3, in sub-rule (5) after the words "may be declared" the words "by the State Government" shall be inserted and there after new proviso is inserted as at (a) above vide **S.O. 2555 dated 10/08/2017**.
15. In rule 5, for the existing sub-rule "*(3) Not withstanding anything contained in sub-rule (2), the State Government may subject to such items and conditions as are necessary to reduce noise pollution permit use of loudspeakers or (public address system and the like during night hours)*[12] *(between 10.00 p.m. to 12.00 midnight) on or during any cultural or religious festive occasion of a limited duration not exceeding fifteen days in all during a calendar year.)*[7] *(The concerned State Government shall generally specify in advance, the number and particulars of the days on which such exemption would be operative)*[13]." a new para is inserted as at (b) above vide **S.O. 2555 dated 10/08/2017**.

[*(4) The noise level at the boundary of the public place, where loudspeaker or public address system or any other noise source is being used shall not exceed 10 dB (A) above the ambient noise standards for the area or 75 dB (A) whichever is lower;*

(5) The peripheral noise level of a privately owned sound system or a sound producing instrument shall not, at the boundary of the private place, exceed by more than 5dB (A) the ambient noise standards specified for the area on which it is used.][16]

[5A. Restrictions on the use of horns, sound emitting construction equipments and bursting of fire crackers.

(1) No horn shall be used in silence zones or during night time in residential areas except during a public emergency.

(2) Sound emitting fire crackers shall not be burst in silence zone or during night time.

(3) *Sound emitting construction equipments shall not be used or operated during night time in residential areas and silence zones.]*[17]

6. Consequences of any violation in silence zone/area.

Whoever, in any place covered under the silence zone/area commits any of the following offence, he shall be liable for penalty under the provisions of the Act:

(i) whoever, plays any music or uses any sound amplifiers,

(ii) whoever, beats a drum or tom-tom or blows a horn either musical or pressure, or trumpet or beats or sounds any instrument, or

(iii) whoever, exhibits any mimetic, musical or other performances of a nature to attract crowds.

[*(iv) whoever, bursts sound emitting fire crackers; or*

(v) whoever, uses a loud speaker or a public address system.][18]

7. Complaints to be made to the authority.

(1) A person may, if the noise level exceeds the ambient noise standards by 10 dB(A) or more given in the corresponding columns against any area/zone *(or, if there is a violation of any provision of these rules regarding restrictions imposed during night time,)*[19] make a complaint to the authority.

(2) The authority shall act on the complaint and take action against the violator in accordance with the provisions of these rules and any other law in force.

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16. In rule 5, after sub-rule (3) new sub-rules (4) & (5) have been inserted as at **(16)** above vide **S.O. 50 dated 11/01/2010.**
17. In the said rules, after rule 5, new rule 5A has been inserted as at **(17)** above vide **S.O.50 dated 11/01/2010.**
18. In the said rules, in rule 6, after the clause (iii) new clauses (iv) & (v), as at **(18)** above have been inserted vide **S.O. 50 dated 11/01/2010.**
19. In the said rules, in rule 7 in sub-rule (1), after the words "in corresponding columns…… & ending with……area/zone", new sentence as at **(19)** above has been inserted vide **S.O.50 dated 11/01/2010.**

8. <u>Power to prohibit etc. continuance of music sound or noise</u>.

(1) If the authority is satisfied from the report of an officer in-charge of a police station or other information received by him (including from the complainant)[20] that it is necessary to do so in order to prevent annoyance, disturbance, discomfort or injury or risk of annoyance, disturbance, discomfort or injury to the public or to any person who dwell or occupy property on the vicinity, he may, by a written order issue such directions as he may consider necessary to any person for preventing, prohibiting, controlling or regulating:

(a) the incidence or continuance in or upon any premises of -

(i) any vocal or instrumental music,

(ii) sounds caused by playing, beating, clashing, blowing or use in any manner whatsoever of any instrument including loudspeakers, *(public address systems, horn, construction equipment, appliance or apparatus)*[22] or contrivance which is capable of producing or re-producing sound, or

[*(iii) sound caused by bursting of sound emitting fire crackers, or*][23]

(b) the carrying on in or upon, any premises of any trade, avocation or operation or process resulting in or attended with noise.

(2) The authority empowered under sub-rule (1) may, either on its own motion, or on the application of any person aggrieved by an order made under sub-rule (1), either rescind, modify or alter any such order:

Provided that before any such application is disposed of, the said authority shall afford to the applicant (and to the original complainant, as the case may be)[21] an opportunity of appearing before it either in person or by a person representing him and showing cause against the order and shall, if it rejects any such application either wholly or in part, record its reasons for such rejection.

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20. In rule 8, in sub-rule (1) after the words "*received by him*" the words "*including from the complainant*" has been inserted as at **(18)** above vide **S.O. 1569 (E) dated 19/09/2006**

21. In rule 8, in sub-rule (2) in the proviso, after the words "*afford to the applicant*", the words "*and to the original complainant, as the case may be*", has been inserted as at **(19)** above vide **S.O. 1569 (E) dated 19/09/2006**

22. In the said rules, in rule 8, in sub-rule (1), in clause (a)in sub-clause (ii), for the words, "public address systems, appliance or apparatus" new words have been substituted as at **(20)** above vide **S.O. 50 dated 11/01/2010.**

23. In the said rules, in rule 8, in sub-rule (1), in clause (a)after sub-clause (ii) new sub-clause (iii) as at **(21)** above has been inserted vide **S.O. 50 dated 11/01/2010.**

SCHEDULE
(see rule 3(l) and 4(l)

Ambient Air Quality Standards in respect of Noise

Area Code	Category of Area/Zone	Limits in dB(A) Leq *	
		Day Time	NightTime
(A)	Industrial area	75	70
(B)	Commercial area	65	55
(C)	Residential area	55	45
(D)	Silence Zone	50	40

Note:-

1. Day time shall mean from 6.00 a.m. to 10.00 p.m.

2. Night time shall mean from 10.00 p.m. to 6.00 a.m.

3. Mixed categories of areas may be declared as one of the four above mentioned categories by the competent authority.

*dB(A) Leq denotes the time weighted average of the level of sound in decibels on scale A which is relatable to human hearing.

A "decibel" is a unit in which noise is measured.

"A", in dB(A) Leq, denotes the frequency weighting in the measurement of noise and corresponds to frequency response characteristics of the human ear.

Leq : It is an energy mean of the noise level, over a specified period.

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24. In the schedule to the said rules, for the note 3 and the entries thereto, *"Silence zone is defined as an area comprising not less than 100 metres around hospitals, educational institutions and courts. The silence zones are zones which are declared as such by the competent authority."* has been substituted as at **(22)** above vide **S.O. 1046 (E) dated 22/11/2000.**

25. In the schedule to the said rules, in the note, paragraph *("3. Silence zone is an area comprising not less than 100 meters around hospitals, educational institutions and courts, religious places or any other area which is declared as such by the competent authority ")*[22] has been omitted as may be seen above vide **S.O. 2555 (E) dated 10/08/2017.**

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Note: **The Principal rules were published in the Gazette of India vide Notification number S.O. 123(E) dated 14 February, 2000 and subsequently amended vide**

1) S.O.1046(E) dated 22/11/2000;

2) S.O.1088(E) dated 11/10/2002;

3) S.O.1569(E) dated 19/09/2006;

4) S.O.50(E) dated 11/01/2010;

5) S.O.2555(E) dated 10/08/2017;

The Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993

No. 10 of 1994*

[8th January, 1994]

An Act to provide for the constitution of National Human Rights Commission, State Human Rights Commissions in States and Human Rights Courts for better protection of human rights and for matters connected therewith or incidental thereto.

Be it enacted by Parliament in the Forty-fourth Year of the Republic of India as follows:-

CHAPTER-I

Preliminary

1. ***Short title, extent and commencement.-*** (1) This Act may be called the Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993.

(2) It extends to the whole of India;

[1][* * *]

(3) It shall be deemed to have come into force on the 28th day of September, 1993.

2. ***Definitions.-***(1) In this Act, unless the context otherwise requires,-

(a) "armed forces" means the naval, military and air forces and includes any other armed forces of the Union;

(b) "Chairperson" means the Chairperson of the Commission or of the State Commission, as the case may be;

[2][(ba) "Chief Commissioner" means the Chief Commissioner for Persons with Disabilities referred to in sub-section (1) of section 74 of the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016 (49 of 2016);]

(c) "Commission" means the National Human Rights Commission constituted under Section 3;

(d) "human rights'' means the rights relating to life, liberty, equality and dignity of the individual guaranteed by the Constitution or embodied in the International Covenants and enforceable by courts in India;

(e) "Human Rights Court'' means the Human Rights Court specified under Section 30;

[3][(f) "International Covenants'' means the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights and the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights adopted by the General Assembly of the United Nations on the 16th December, 1966 and such other Covenant or Convention adopted by the General Assembly of the United Nations as the Central Government may, by notification, specify;]

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* Received the assent of the President on the 8th January, 1994 and Act Published in the Gazette of India (Extraordinary) Part II Section 1 dated 10-1-1994.

1. Proviso omitted by the Jammu & Kashmir Reorganization Act, 2019 (34 of 2019), Section 95, 96 and Fifth Schedule, Table-1. Proviso before omission, stood as under :
"Provided that it shall apply to the State of Jammu and Kashmir only insofar as it pertains to the matters relatable to any of the entries enumerated in List I or List III in the Seventh Schedule to the Constitution as applicable to that State."
2. Inserted by Act No. 19 of 2019, Section 2(i).
3. Substituted by Act No. 43 of 2006, w.e.f. 23-11-2006.

[1][(g) "Member" means a Member of the Commission or of the State Commission, as the case may be;]

[2][(ga) "National Commission for Backward Classes" means the National Commission for Backward Classes constituted under section 3 of the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 (27 of 1993);]

(h) "National Commission for Minorities" means the National Commission for Minorities constituted under Section 3 of the National Commission for Minorities Act, 1992 (19 of 1992);

[2][(ha) "National Commission for Protection of Child Rights" means the National Commission for Protection of Child Rights constituted under section 3 of the Commission for Protection of Child Rights Act, 2005 (4 of 2006);]

[1][(i) "National Commission for the Scheduled Castes" means the National Commission for the Scheduled Castes referred to in article 338 of the Constitution;

[1](ia) "National Commission for the Scheduled Tribes" means the National Commission for the Scheduled Tribes referred to in article 338A of the Constitution;]

(j) "National Commission for Women" means the National Commission for Women constituted under Section 3 of the National Commission for Women Act, 1990 (20 of 1990);

(k) "notification" means a notification published in the Official Gazette;

(l) "prescribed" means prescribed by rules made under this Act;

(m) "public servant" shall have the meaning assigned to it in section 21of the Indian Penal Code (45 of 1860);

(n) "State Commission" means a State Human Rights Commission constituted under Section 21.

(2) Any reference in this Act to a law, which is not in force in the State of Jammu and Kashmir, shall, in relation to that State, be construed as a reference to a corresponding law, if any, in force in that State.

CHAPTER-II

The National Human Rights Commission

3. Constitution of National Human Rights Commission.- (1) The Central Government shall constitute a body to be known as the National Human Rights Commission to exercise the powers conferred upon, and to perform the functions assigned to it, under this Act.

(2) The Commission shall consist of—

(a) a Chairperson who has been a [3][Chief Justice of India or a Judge] of the Supreme Court;

(b) one Member who is, or has been, a Judge of the Supreme Court;

(c) one Member who is, or has been the Chief Justice of a High Court;

(d) [4][three Members, out of which at least one shall be a woman,] to be

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1. Substituted by Act No. 43 of 2006, w.e.f. 23-11-2006.
2. Inserted by Act No. 19 of 2019.
3. Substituted by Act No. 19 of 2019, for the words "Chief Justice"
4. Substituted by Act No. 19 of 2019, for the words "two Members"

appointed from amongst persons having knowledge of, or practical experience in, matters relating to human rights.

(3) The Chairperson of [1][the National Commission for Backward Classes, the National Commission for Minorities, the National Commission for Protection of Child Rights], [2][the National Commission for the Scheduled Castes, the National Commission for the Scheduled Tribes], [3][the National Commission for Women and the Chief Commissioner for Persons with Disabilities] shall be deemed to be Members of the Commission for the discharge of functions specified in clauses (b) to (j) of Section 12.

(4) There shall be a Secretary-General who shall be the Chief Executive Officer of the Commission and [4][shall, subject to control of the Chairperson, exercise all administrative and financial powers (except judicial functions and the power to make regulations under section 40B)].

(5) The headquarters of the Commission shall be at Delhi and the Commission may, with the previous approval of the Central Government, establish offices at other places in India.

4. ***Appointment of Chairperson and other Members.-***(1) The Chairperson and [2][the Members] shall be appointed by the President by warrant under his hand and seal:

Provided that every appointment under this sub-section shall be made after obtaining the recommendations of a Committee consisting of-

(a) the Prime Minister	-Chairperson;
(b) Speaker of the House of the People	-Member;
(c) Minister in-charge of the Ministry of Home Affairs in the Government of India	-Member;
(d) Leader of the Opposition in the House of the People	-Member;
(e) Leader of the Opposition in the Council of States	-Member;
(f) Deputy Chairman of the Council of States	-Member:

Provided further that no sitting Judge of the Supreme Court or sitting Chief Justice of a High Court shall be appointed except after consultation with the Chief Justice of India.

(2) No appointment of a Chairperson or a Member shall be invalid merely by reason of any [5][vacancy of any member in the Committee referred to in the first proviso to sub-section (1)].

[5]***[5. Resignation and removal of Chairperson and Members.-*** (1) The Chairperson or any Member may, by notice in writing under his hand addressed to the President of India, resign his office.

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1. Substituted by Act No. 19 of 2019, for the words "the National Commission for Minorities".
2. Substituted by Act No. 43 of 2006, w.e.f. 23-11-2006.
3. Substituted by Act No. 19 of 2019, for the words "and the National Commission for Women".
4. Substituted by Act No. 19 of 2019, for the words "shall exercise such powers and discharge such functions of the Commission (except judicial functions and the power to make regulations under section 40B) as may be delegated to him by the Commission or the Chairperson, as the case may be."
5. Substituted by Act No. 43 of 2006, w.e.f. 23-11-2006.

(2) Subject to the provisions of sub-section (3), the Chairperson or any Member shall only be removed from his office by order of the President of India on the ground of proved misbehavior or incapacity after the Supreme Court, on reference being made to it by the President, has, on inquiry held in accordance with the procedure prescribed in that behalf by the Supreme Court, reported that the Chairperson or the Member, as the case may be, ought on any such ground to be removed.

(3) Notwithstanding anything in sub-section (2), the President may, by order, remove from office the Chairperson or any Member if the Chairperson or such Member, as the case may be,-

(a) is adjudged an insolvent; or

(b) engages during his term of office in any paid employment outside the duties of his office; or

(c) is unfit to continue in office by reason of infirmity of mind or body; or

(d) is of unsound mind and stands so declared by a competent court;

(e) is convicted and sentenced to imprisonment of an offence which in the opinion of the President involves moral turpitude.]

[1][**6. *Term of office of Chairperson and Members.-*** (1) A person appointed as Chairperson shall hold office for a term of [2][three years] from the date on which he enters upon his office or until he attains the age of seventy years, whichever is earlier [3][and shall be eligible for re-appointment].

(2) A person appointed as Member shall hold office for a term of [4][three years] from the date on which he enters upon his office and shall be eligible for re-appointment [5][* * *]:

Provided that no Member shall hold office after he has attained the age of seventy years.

(3) On ceasing to hold office, a Chairperson or a Member shall be ineligible for further employment under the Government of India or under the Government of any State.]

7. Member to act as Chairperson or to discharge his functions in certain circumstances. - (1) In the event of the occurrence of any vacancy in the office of the Chairperson by reason of his death, resignation or otherwise, the President may, by notification, authorize one of the Members to act as the Chairperson until the appointment of a new Chairperson to fill such vacancy.

(2) When the Chairperson is unable to discharge his functions owing to absence or leave or otherwise, such one of the Members as the President may, by notification, authorize in this behalf, shall discharge the functions of the Chairperson until the date on which the Chairperson resumes his duties.

[6][**8. *Terms and conditions of service of Chairperson and Members***.- The salaries and allowances payable to, and the other terms and conditions of service of, the Chairperson and Members shall be such as may be prescribed:

1. Substituted by Act No. 43 of 2006, w.e.f. 23-11-2006.
2. Substituted by Act No. 19 of 2019, for the words "five years".
3. Inserted by Act No. 19 of 2019.
4. Substituted by Act No. 19 of 2019, sec. 4(ii) (a), for "five years".
5. The words "for another term of five years" omitted by Act No. 19 of 2019, sec. 4(ii) (b).
6. Substituted by Act 43 of 2006, sec. 7, for sections (w.e.f. 23-11-2006).

Provided that neither the salary and allowances nor the other terms and conditions of service of the Chairperson or a Member shall be varied to his disadvantage after his appointment.

9. *Vacancies, etc., not to invalidate the proceedings of the Commission.-* No act or proceedings of the Commission shall be questioned or shall be invalidated merely on the ground of existence of any vacancy or defect in the constitution of the Commission.

10. *Procedure to be regulated by the Commission.-*(1) The Commission shall meet at such time and place as the Chairperson may think fit.

[1][(2) Subject to the provisions of this Act and the rules made thereunder, the Commission shall have the power to lay down by regulations its own procedure.]

(3) All orders and decisions of the Commission shall be authenticated by the Secretary-General or any other officer of the Commission duly authorised by the Chairperson in this behalf.

11. Officers and other staff of the Commission.-(1) The Central Government shall make available to the Commission-

(a) an officer of the rank of the Secretary to the Government of India who shall be the Secretary-General of the Commission; and

(b) such police and investigative staff under an officer not below the rank of a Director General of Police and such other officers and staff as may be necessary for the efficient performance of the functions of the Commission.

(2) Subject to such rules as may be made by the Central Government in this behalf, the Commission may appoint such other administrative, technical and scientific staff as it may consider necessary.

(3) The salaries, allowances and conditions of service of the officers and other staff appointed under sub-section (2) shall be such as may be prescribed.

CHAPTER-III

Functions and Powers of the Commission

12. *Functions of the Commission.-*The Commission shall perform all or any of the following functions, namely:-

(a) inquire, *suo motu* or on a petition presented to it by a victim or any person on his behalf [2][or on a direction or order of any court], into complaint of-

(i) violation of human rights or abetment thereof; or

(ii) negligence in the prevention of such violation, by a public servant;

(b) intervene in any proceeding involving any allegation of violation of human rights pending before a Court with the approval of such Court;

[3][(c) visit, notwithstanding anything contained in any other law for the time being in force, any jail or other institution under the control of the State Government, where persons are detained or lodged for purposes of treatment, reformation or protection, for the study of the living conditions of the inmates thereof and make recommendations thereon to the Government;]

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1. Substituted by Act No. 43 of 2006, w.e.f. 23-11-2006.
2. Inserted by Act No. 43 of 2006, w.e.f. 23-11-2006.
3. Substituted by Act No. 43 of 2006, for clause (c) (w.e.f. 23-11-2006).

(d) review the safeguards provided by or under the Constitution or any law for the time being in force for the protection of human rights and recommend measures for their effective implementation;

(e) review the factors, including acts of terrorism, that inhibit the enjoyment of human rights and recommend appropriate remedial measures;

(f) study treaties and other international instruments on human rights and make recommendations for their effective implementation;

(g) undertake and promote research in the field of human rights;

(h) spread human rights literacy among various sections of society and promote awareness of the safeguards available for the protection of these rights through publications, the media, seminars and other available means;

(i) encourage the efforts of non-governmental organizations and institutions working in the field of human rights;

(j) such other functions as it may consider necessary for the promotion of human rights.

13. ***Powers relating to inquiries.***-(1) The Commission shall, while inquiring into complaints under this Act, have all the powers of a Civil Court trying a suit under the Code of Civil Procedure, 1908 and in particular in respect of the following matters, namely:-

(a) summoning and enforcing the attendance of witnesses and examining them on oath;

(b) discovery and production of any document;

(c) receiving evidence on affidavits;

(d) requisitioning any public record or copy thereof from any Court or office;

(e) issuing commissions for the examination of witnesses or documents;

(f) any other matter which may be prescribed.

(2) The Commission shall have power to require any person, subject to any privilege which may be claimed by that person under any law for the time being in force, to furnish information on such points or matters as, in the opinion of the Commission, may be useful for, or relevant to, the subject matter of the inquiry and any person so required shall be deemed to be legally bound to furnish such information within the meaning of section 176 and section 177 of the Indian Penal Code.

(3) The Commission or any other officer, not below the rank of a Gazetted Officer, specially authorized in this behalf by the Commission may enter any building or place where the Commission has reason to believe that any document relating to the subject-matter of the inquiry may be found, and may seize any such document or take extracts or copies therefrom subject to the provisions of section 100 of the Code of Criminal Procedure, 1973, insofar as it may be applicable.

(4) The Commission shall be deemed to be a Civil Court and when any offence as is described in section 175, section 178, section 179, section 180 or section 228 of the Indian Penal Code is committed in the view or presence of the Commission, the Commission may, after recording the facts constituting the offence and the statement of the accused as provided for in the Code of Criminal Procedure, 1973, forward the case to a Magistrate having jurisdiction to try the same and the Magistrate to whom any such case is forwarded shall proceed to hear the complaint against

the accused as if the case has been forwarded to him under section 346 of the Code of Criminal Procedure, 1973.

(5) Every proceeding before the Commission shall be deemed to be a judicial proceeding within the meaning of sections 193 and 228, and for the purposes of section 196, of the Indian Penal Code, and the Commission shall be deemed to be a civil Court for all the purposes of section 195 and Chapter XXVI of the Code of Criminal Procedure, 1973.

[1][(6) Where the Commission considers it necessary or expedient so to do, it may, by order, transfer any complaint filed or pending before it to the State Commission of the State from which the complaint arises, for disposal in accordance with the provisions of this Act:

Provided that no such complaint shall be transferred unless the same is one respecting which the State Commission has jurisdiction to entertain the same.

(7) Every complaint transferred under sub-section (6) shall be dealt with and disposed of by the State Commission as if it were a complaint initially filed before it.]

14. ***Investigation.-***(1) The Commission may, for the purpose of conducting any investigation pertaining to the inquiry, utilize the services of any officer or investigation agency of the Central Government or any State Government with the concurrence of the Central Government or the State Government, as the case may be.

(2) For the purpose of investigating into any matter pertaining to the inquiry, any officer or agency whose services are utilized under sub-section (1) may, subject to the direction and control of the Commission,-

(a) summon and enforce the attendance of any person and examine him;

(b) require the discovery and production of any document; and

(c) requisition any public record or copy thereof from any office.

(3) The provisions of section 15 shall apply in relation to any statement made by a person before any officer or agency whose services are utilized under sub-section (1) as they apply in relation to any statement made by a person in the course of giving evidence before the Commission.

(4) The officer or agency whose services are utilized under sub-section (1) shall investigate into any matter pertaining to the inquiry and submit a report thereon to the Commission within such period as may be specified by the Commission in this behalf.

(5) The Commission shall satisfy itself about the correctness of the facts stated and the conclusion, if any, arrived at in the report submitted to it under sub-section (4) and for this purpose the Commission may make such inquiry (including the examination of the person or persons who conducted or assisted in the investigation) as it thinks fit.

15. ***Statement made by persons to the Commission.-***No statement made by a person in the course of giving evidence before the Commission shall subject him to, or be used against him in, any civil or criminal proceeding except a prosecution for giving false evidence by such statement:

Provided that the statement-

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1. Inserted by Act No. 43 of 2006, w.e.f. 23-11-2006.

(a) is made in reply to the question which he is required by the Commission to answer; or

(b) is relevant to the subject matter of the inquiry.

16. ***Persons likely to be prejudicially affected to be heard.***-If, at any stage of the inquiry, the Commission-

(a) consider it necessary to inquire into the conduct of any person; or

(b) is of the opinion that the reputation of any person is likely to be prejudicially affected by the inquiry, it shall give to that person a reasonable opportunity of being heard in the inquiry and to produce evidence in his defence:

Provided that nothing in this section shall apply where the credit of a witness is being impeached.

CHAPTER-IV

Procedure

17. ***Inquiry into complaints.***-The Commission while inquiring into the complaints of violations of human rights may-

(i) call for information or report from the Central Government or any State Government or any other authority or organization subordinate thereto within such time as may be specified by it:

Provided that-

(a) if the information or report is not received within the time stipulated by the Commission, it may proceed to inquire into the complaint on its own;

(b) if, on receipt of information or report, the Commission is satisfied either that no further inquiry is required or that the required action has been initiated or taken by the concerned Government or authority, it may not proceed with the complaint and inform the complainant accordingly;

(ii) without prejudice to anything contained in clause (i), if it considers necessary, having regard to the nature of the complaint, initiate an inquiry.

[1][**18.** ***Steps during and after inquiry.***-The Commission may take any of the following steps during or upon the completion of an inquiry held under this Act, namely:-

(a) where the inquiry discloses the commission of violation of human rights or negligence in the prevention of violation of human rights or abetment thereof by a public servant, it may recommend to the concerned Government or authority-

(i) to make payment of compensation or damages to the complainant or to the victim or the members of his family as the Commission may consider necessary;

(ii) to initiate proceedings for prosecution or such other suitable action as the Commission may deem fit against the concerned person or persons;

(iii) to take such further action as it may think fit;

(b) approach the Supreme Court or the High Court concerned for such directions, orders or writs as that Court may deem necessary;

(c) recommend to the concerned Government or authority at any stage of the inquiry for the grant of such immediate interim relief to the victim or the members of his family as the Commission may consider necessary;

1. Substituted by Act No. 43 of 2006, w.e.f. 23-11-2006.

(d) subject to the provisions of clause (e), provide a copy of the inquiry report to the petitioner or his representative;

(e) the Commission shall send a copy of its inquiry report together with its recommendations to the concerned Government or authority and the concerned Government or authority shall, within a period of one month, or such further time as the Commission may allow, forward its comments on the report, including the action taken or proposed to be taken thereon, to the Commission;

(f) the Commission shall publish its inquiry report together with the comments of the concerned Government or authority, if any, and the action taken or proposed to be taken by the concerned Government or authority on the recommendations of the Commission.]

19. ***Procedure with respect to armed forces.***-(1) Notwithstanding anything contained in this Act, while dealing with complaints of violation of human rights by members of the armed forces, the Commission shall adopt the following procedure, namely:-

(a) it may, either on its own motion or on receipt of a petition, seek a report from the Central Government;

(b) after the receipt of the report, it may, either not proceed with the complaint or, as the case may be, make its recommendations to that Government.

(2) The Central Government shall inform the Commission of the action taken on the recommendations within three months or such further time as the Commission may allow.

(3) The Commission shall publish its report together with its recommendations made to the Central Government and the action taken by that Government on such recommendations.

(4) The Commission shall provide a copy of the report published under sub-section (3) to the petitioner or his representative.

20. ***Annual and special reports of the Commission.***-(1) The Commission shall submit an annual report to the Central Government and to the State Government concerned and may at any time submit special reports on any matter which, in its opinion, is of such urgency or importance that it should not be deferred till submission of the annual report.

(2) The Central Government and the State Government, as the case may be, shall cause the annual and special reports of the Commission to be laid before each House of Parliament or the State Legislature respectively, as the case may be, alongwith a memorandum of action taken or proposed to be taken on the recommendations of the Commission and the reasons for non-acceptance of the recommendations, if any.

CHAPTER-V

State Human Rights Commissions

21. ***Constitution of State Human Rights Commissions.***-(1) A State Government may constitute a body to be known as the ……(Name of the State) Human Rights Commission to exercise the powers conferred upon, and to perform the functions assigned to, a State Commission under this Chapter.

[1][(2) The State Commission shall, with effect from such date as the State Government may by notification specify, consist of-

(a) a Chairperson who has been a [2][Chief Justice or a Judge] of a High Court;

(b) one Member who is, or has been, a Judge of a High Court or District Judge in the State with a minimum of seven years experience as District Judge;

(c) one Member to be appointed from among persons having knowledge of or practical experience in matters relating to human rights.]

(3) There shall be a Secretary who shall be the Chief Executive Officer of the State Commission and [3][shall, subject to control of the Chairperson, exercise all administrative and financial powers of the State Commission].

(4) The headquarters of the State Commission shall be at such place as the State Government may, by notification, specify.

(5) A State Commission may inquire into violation of human rights only in respect of matters relatable to any of the entries enumerated in List II and List III in the Seventh Schedule to the Constitution:

Provided that if any such matter is already being inquired into by the Commission or any other Commission duly constituted under any law for the time being in force, the State Commission shall not inquire into the said matter:

Provided further that in relation to the Jammu and Kashmir Human Rights Commission, this sub-section shall have effect as if for the words and figures "List II and List III in the Seventh Schedule to the Constitution", the words and figures "List III in the Seventh Schedule of the Constitution as applicable to the State of Jammu and Kashmir and in respect of matters in relation to which the Legislature of that State has power to make laws" had been substituted.

[4][(6) Two or more State Governments may, with the consent of a Chairperson or Member of a State Commission, appoint such Chairperson or, as the case may be, such Member of another State Commission simultaneously if such Chairperson or Member consents to such appointment:

Provided that every appointment made under this sub-section shall be made after obtaining the recommendations of the Committee referred to in sub-section (1) of section 22 in respect of the State for which a common Chairperson or Member, or both, as the case may be, is to be appointed.]

[5][(7) Subject to the provisions of section 12, the Central Government may, by order, confer upon the State Commission the functions relating to human rights being discharged by the Union territories, other than the Union territory of Delhi.]

[5][(8) The functions relating to human rights in case of Union territory of Delhi shall be dealt with by the Commission.]

22. *Appointment of Chairperson and [6][Members] of State Commission.-*

(1) The Chairperson and [6][Members] shall be appointed by the Governor by warrant under his hand and seal:

Provided that every appointment under this sub-section shall be made after

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1. Substituted by Act No. 43 of 2006, w.e.f. 23-11-2006.
2. Substituted by Act No. 19 of 2019, for the words "Chief Justice".
3. Substituted by Act No. 19 of 2019, for the words "shall exercise such powers and discharge such functions of the State Commission as it may delegate to him".
4. Inserted by Act No. 43 of 2006, w.e.f. 23-11-2006.
5. Inserted by Act No. 19 of 2019.
6. Substituted by Act No. 43 of 2006, w.e.f. 23-11-2006

incurred in connection with such audit shall be payable by the Commission to the Comptroller and Auditor-General.

(3) The Comptroller and Auditor-General and any person appointed by him in connection with the audit of the accounts of the Commission under this Act shall have the same rights and privileges and the authority in connection with such audit as the Comptroller and Auditor-General generally has in connection with the audit of Government accounts and, in particular, shall have the right to demand the production of books, accounts, connected vouchers and other documents and papers and to inspect any of the offices of the Commission.

(4) The accounts of the Commission, as certified by the Comptroller and Auditor-General or any other person appointed by him in this behalf, together with audit report thereon shall be forwarded annually to the Central Government by the Commission and the Central Government shall cause the audit report to be laid, as soon as may be, after it is received, before each House of Parliament.

35. ***Accounts and audit of State Commission.***-(1) The State Commission shall maintain proper accounts and other relevant records and prepare an annual statement of accounts in such form as may be prescribed by the State Government in consultation with the Comptroller and Auditor-General of India.

(2) The accounts of the State Commission shall be audited by the Comptroller and Auditor-General at such intervals as may be specified by him and any expenditure incurred in connection with such audit shall be payable by the State Commission to the Comptroller and Auditor-General.

(3) The Comptroller and Auditor-General and any person appointed by him in connection with the audit of the accounts of the State Commission under this Act shall have the same rights and privileges and the authority in connection with such audit as the Comptroller and Auditor-General generally has in connection with the audit of Government accounts and, in particular, shall have the right to demand the production of books, accounts, connected vouchers and other documents and paper and to inspect any of the offices of the State Commission.

(4) The accounts of the State Commission, as certified by the Comptroller and Auditor-General or any other person appointed by him in this behalf, together with the audit report thereon, shall be forwarded annually to the State Government by the State Commission and the State Government shall cause the audit report to be laid, as soon as may be after it is received, before the State Legislature.

CHAPTER-VIII

Miscellaneous

36. ***Matters not subject to jurisdiction of the Commission.***-(1) The Commission shall not inquire into any matter which is pending before a State Commission or any other Commission duly constituted under any law for the time being in force.

(2) The Commission or the State Commission shall not inquire into any matter after the expiry of one year from the date on which the act constituting violation of human rights is alleged to have been committed.

37. ***Constitution of special investigation teams.***-Notwithstanding anything contained in any other law for the time being in force, where the Government considers it necessary so to do, it may constitute one or more special investigation teams, consisting of such police officers as it thinks necessary for purposes of investigation and prosecution of offences arising out of violation of human rights.

Research Unit
Press Information Bureau
Government of India

10TH NATIONAL HANDLOOM DAY: CELEBRATING TRADITION, INNOVATION, AND EXCELLENCE

Honoring India's Weaving Legacy

(Ministry of Textiles)

August 6, 2024

National Handloom Day, observed on August 7, marks the anniversary of the Swadeshi Movement of 1905 and was first celebrated in 2015, inaugurated by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in Chennai. The **10th National Handloom Day** will take place on August 7, 2024, at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi. This day honours the contributions of handloom workers and aims to inspire pride and motivation within the handloom industry by highlighting their cultural, traditional, and **economic significance**. The event is celebrated nationwide to raise awareness of the handloom sector's role in **socio-economic development**.



The handloom sector is a vibrant representation of India's diverse cultural heritage, employing around **3.5 million people**, making it the second-largest employment sector after agriculture. With each region offering unique styles and patterns—from Jammu & Kashmir's Pashmina Shawls to Kerala's Kasaragod Sarees and Gujarat's Patan Patola—handloom products embody centuries of artisanal skill and cultural richness.

These products also play a crucial role in empowering millions of artisans, **especially women**, by providing essential livelihoods and aiding in rural **poverty alleviation**.

Government Initiatives to Support Handloom Weavers

The government has introduced several initiatives to bolster India's handloom sector, aimed at improving weavers' conditions and boosting productivity:

1. **GeM Onboarding:** Allows weavers to sell directly to government departments via the Government e-Marketplace (GeM).
2. **Handloom Producer Companies:** 124 companies formed across states, with UNDP aiding in the capacity building of 100 of these companies.
3. **Engagement with E-commerce Entities:** Collaboration with 23 e-commerce platforms to expand market access for handloom products.
4. **Design Resource Centers (DRCs):** Established in major cities to enhance design excellence in handlooms.
5. **Weavers' Welfare Scheme:** Includes National Handloom Development Programme (NHDP), Comprehensive Handloom Cluster Development Scheme (CHCDS), Handloom Weavers' Comprehensive Welfare Scheme (HWCWS), Yarn Supply Scheme (YSS), and Hathkargha Samvardhan Sahayata.
6. **Handloom Export Scheme:** Supports the export of handloom products and participation in international fairs.
7. **Weaver MUDRA Scheme:** Offers financial assistance for working capital and new technology investments.
8. **Cluster Development Programme:** Provides funds for infrastructure, capacity building, and market access in handloom clusters.

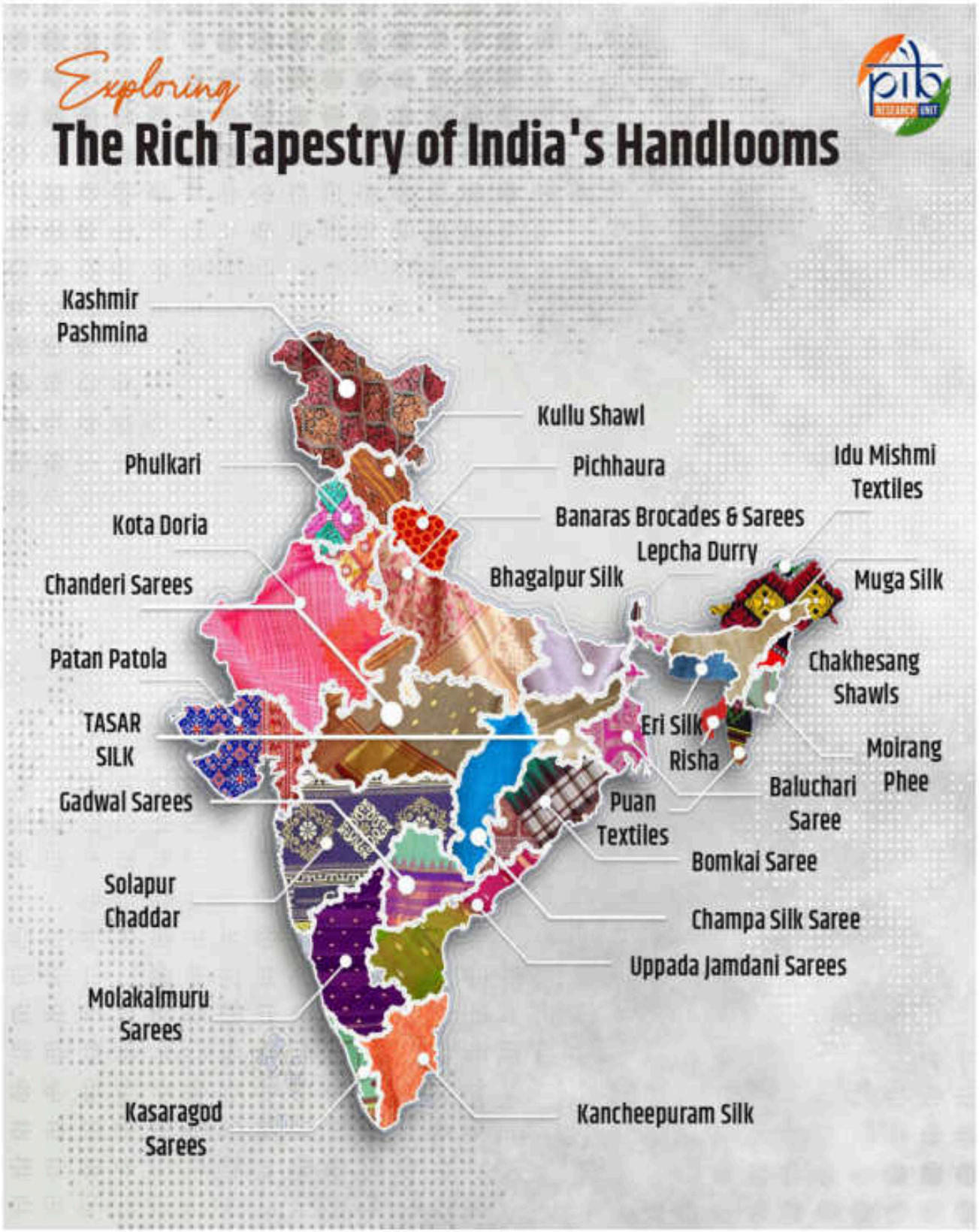
Unveiling India's Handloom Legacy: A Rich Tapestry of Tradition

Indian handlooms are a vibrant and integral part of the nation's cultural heritage. This sector employs over **35 lakh individuals**, including **25 lakh female weavers** and allied workers, making a substantial contribution to the economy.

With the government's initiatives in cluster development, credit availability, export promotion, and the establishment of seven Design Resource Centres (DRCs) for design excellence, Indian handlooms continue to be a beloved choice for traditional and contemporary fashion both within India and worldwide.

Exploring

The Rich Tapestry of India's Handlooms



GI Tags to Protect the Handloom Industry

Geographical Indication (GI) tags are official markers given to products with a specific geographic origin and distinct qualities. They protect these products from unauthorized use or imitation, helping consumers identify authentic goods. In India, the Geographical Indications of **Goods (Registration & Protection) Act, 1999**, enacted in 2003, aims to safeguard producers' interests, prevent exploitation of GIs, and boost marketability.

From April 2023 to March 2024, the government awarded GI tags to several handloom products, enhancing their recognition and economic value. These products include:

- **Barabanki** Handloom Products from Uttar Pradesh
- **Chedibutta** Saree from Tamil Nadu
- Jodhpur **Bandhej** Craft from Rajasthan
- **Basohli Pashmina** Woolen Products from Jammu & Kashmir
- **Rangwali Pichhoda** of Kumaon from Uttarakhand
- **Tangail Saree** from West Bengal
- **Garad Saree** from West Bengal
- **Korial saree** from West Bengal



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National Handloom Day 2026

Celebrating Weavers, Renewing Traditions, Expanding Horizons

August 06, 2026

Observed on 7 August, National Handloom Day celebrates India's weaving heritage. It recognises 35.22 lakh weavers and allied workers, over 72% of whom are women. In 2026, the occasion reflects a sector firmly rooted in regional knowledge. Handlooms are also finding new expression through design, digital platforms and global markets. Government support, awards, market access and authenticity safeguards are carrying these traditions from rural communities to wider national and international audiences.

National Handloom Day 2026 in a changing textile landscape

India's handloom tradition has deep historical roots, with its earliest traces dating back to the Indus Valley Civilisation. Spinning and weaving find mention across the Rigveda, the Ramayana and the Mahabharata. The fine quality of Indian cotton and silk is also documented in these texts and in the works of Kautilya.

Over the centuries, weaving skills and techniques have been passed down from one generation to the next. These traditions have evolved through the distinctive practices of different regions across India. The institution of **National Handloom Day in 2015** gave this long-standing heritage a dedicated national platform.

National Handloom Day

National Handloom Day is celebrated annually on **7 August**. It commemorates the launch of the **Swadeshi Movement in 1905**, which promoted indigenous goods and encouraged self-reliance. The occasion **celebrates India's weaving traditions** and recognises the socio-economic and cultural **contribution of handloom workers**.

In 2026, the observance marks an important point in this journey. It reflects the growing relevance of handloom among contemporary consumers and its greater visibility in global markets.

Handloom weaving remains rooted in manual craftsmanship and household enterprises. Its identity is closely connected to the weaver, the region and the knowledge involved in creating each textile. At the same time, the landscape around handloom continues to evolve. Contemporary design, digital platforms and national and international showcases are connecting Indian weaves with newer consumers and expanding their visibility.

The People Behind India's Handlooms

The Fourth All India Handloom Census 2019-20, the comprehensive official census of the sector, recorded around **31.45 lakh handloom households**. It also counted **35.22 lakh handloom weavers** and allied workers across the country. Of these, **8.48 lakh** were allied workers engaged in **pre-loom and post-loom activities** such as winding, warping, dyeing and calendaring. Further, social and geographical patterns show that handloom is closely tied to rural livelihoods.

Handloom Census

- India has conducted four censuses so far: 1987-88, 1995-96, 2009-10 and 2019-20.
- They are conducted at intervals averaging 8-12 years.

Recognising and Registering Handloom Workers

Workers enumerated through the Census have been provided Pehchan/ e-Pehchan cards. To further extend this coverage, the e-Pehchan portal was launched in January 2025. It allows new and previously left-out workers to register, while existing workers can update details and download their cards.

By July 2026, around **84,000 additional workers** had been approved for **e-Pehchan cards**.

A Sector Driven by Women

Women form the majority of India's handloom workforce. They account for **25.46 lakh**, or **more than 72% of the total workers** engaged in weaving and allied activities.

A Sector Supporting Diverse Communities

The handloom workforce included **4.84 lakh Scheduled Caste workers**, **6.28 lakh Scheduled Tribe workers** and **12.67 lakh workers belonging to Other Backward Classes**.

Furthermore, the census recorded **28.20 lakh looms across the country**. Of these, 25.30 lakh were situated in rural areas and 2.90 lakh in urban areas. Thus, placing **nearly nine out of every ten handlooms in rural India**.

An Ecosystem of Support for Handloom Weavers

The **National Handloom Development Programme** and the **Raw Material Supply Scheme** form the core operational support system for the sector.

I. National Handloom Development Programme (NHDP)



NHDP was formulated for implementation from 2021-22 to 2025-26. It follows a **need-based approach** to the **integrated development of the handloom sector**, focusing on the welfare of handloom weavers.

NHDP components are implemented through Government handloom organisations, as well as national and State-level handloom corporations. Implementing agencies also include weavers' cooperative societies, federations, Handloom Producer Companies and participating banks.

Handloom Producer Companies organise weavers into professionally managed, member-owned enterprises. Under NHDP, **200 HPC** were formed during 2020-21 to 2026-27.

The Programme delivers its wider support through the following **key components**:

a) Small Cluster Development Programme (SCDP)

SCDP supports small handloom clusters with **funding of up to ₹2 crore** to address their specific development needs. The assistance covers better looms, lighting and worksheds, alongside design, product development and marketing.

- **From 2021-22 to 2026-27 (till June), 357 clusters were sanctioned** under the programme.
- Additionally, during 2025-26, **₹94 crore was released for key interventions** such as worksheds, looms and accessories, and electronic jacquards.

SCDP's Impact
Construction of Worksheds: Workshed construction under the Programme provides handloom beneficiaries with improved workspace infrastructure. Weavers receive a subsidy of

up to 100% for constructing these worksheds. The intervention has recorded the following outcomes:

- **Average daily production** increased **by 53%.**
- **Average working hours** rose **by 60%,** while monthly working days increased by 28%.
- **Average daily earnings** increased **by 42%,** from ₹328 to ₹465.

Electronic Jacquard: Electronic jacquards use digital controls to manipulate individual warp threads, enabling faster, more flexible and intricate weaving. Their introduction has improved productivity and earnings among handloom weavers.



- **Average daily production** increased by 55%.
- **96% of beneficiaries** reported **productivity gains**.
- **Average daily wages** rose **by 56%**, from ₹360 to ₹560.
- **Average monthly income** increased from ₹9,600 to ₹15,000.

b) Handloom Marketing Assistance (HMA)

Handloom Marketing Assistance provides weavers and handloom organisations with direct platforms to sell their products. It supports domestic and export promotion, setting up of Urban Haats and marketing incentives. Key achievements under various components include:

- **Between 2021-22 to 2026-27 (till June), 960+ events were organised** to facilitate the sale of handloom products at the district, state and national levels. These included National, State and District Handloom Expos, Craft Melas and other marketing events.
- Under HMA, two national-level awards, **The Sant Kabir Handloom Award and The National Handloom Award** recognise outstanding contributions to the handloom sector. The latest completed award cycle covered the 2024 awards, presented on National Handloom Day 2025. A total **of 24 recipients were honoured**, including **5 Sant Kabir** and **19 National Handloom awardees.** The awardees included **six women and one Divyang weaver.**

The Sant Kabir Handloom Award recognises outstanding weavers for exceptional skills and contributions to weaving traditions, community welfare and sector development. The award carries ₹3.5 lakh, a mounted gold coin, tamrapatra, shawl and certificate.

The National Handloom Award honours craftsmanship, dedication and innovation and includes ₹2 lakh, a tamrapatra, shawl and certificate.

c) Concessional Credit/Weaver MUDRA Scheme

The scheme provides handloom-sector loans at a **concessional 6% interest rate for three years**. This is further supported by government interest subvention of up to 7%. It also offers margin money assistance and covers credit guarantee fees. **The Handloom Weaver MUDRA Portal supports the timely transfer of financial assistance.**

- **Between 2021-22 to 2026-27** (till June), a total of **~40,000+ loans,** amounting to **~₹280+ crore**, were sanctioned.
- **As on 2026-27, a total of 967 loans**, amounting to **₹7.45 crore**, were sanctioned.

d) Handloom Weavers' Welfare (Social Security measures)

The weavers' welfare measures provide social security to handloom weavers and workers, along with scholarships for their children. These include:

- **Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana (PMJJBY):** PMJJBY provides annually renewable life insurance to handloom weavers and workers aged **18-50 years**. It offers a benefit of **₹2 lakh in the event of death due to any cause.**
- **Pradhan Mantri Suraksha Bima Yojana (PMSBY):** PMSBY provides annually renewable accident insurance to handloom weavers and workers **aged 18-70 years**. It offers **₹2 lakh for accidental death or permanent total disability** and **₹1 lakh for permanent partial disability.**

Performance of PMJJBY and PMSBY

- **Enrolment** increased from 1,11,957 handloom weavers and workers in 2021-22 to 2,02,393 in 2026-27(till May), **registering an increase of 80.8%.**
- During this period, **funds released** rose from **₹204.83 lakh to ₹335 lakh**, an increase of **63.6%.**

- **Scholarship:** Scholarships of up to ₹2 lakh annually support two children per handloom worker pursuing recognised textile diploma, undergraduate or postgraduate courses. Since inception, 531 applications were sanctioned by June 2026.

e) Mega Cluster Development Programme

Under the Mega Cluster Development Programme, each mega handloom cluster covers at least 10,000 handlooms/clusters and can receive **central assistance of up to ₹30 crore over five years.**

- **Eight Mega clusters are completed** and functional and **Four Mega clusters are under implementation**.
- Under the Programme, **financial assistance of ₹370.72 crore was released**, benefiting a total of **1,62,682 handloom weavers**.

f) Need Based Special Infrastructure Projects

Under the Programme, assistance of up to **₹12 crore is provided** for product development, productivity, quality improvement, value addition and marketing.

- **Six Craft Handloom Villages** are operational and **three are under implementation**.

II. Raw Material Supply Scheme (RMSS)

The Scheme supports access to yarn **by reimbursing freight charges on all types of yarn**. It also provides a **15% price subsidy** on specified yarns, subject to prescribed quantity limits.



NHDP and RMSS continue to be implemented in 2026-27, with budgetary allocations of **₹205 crore and ₹200 crore,** respectively.

III. GST Relief for Handlooms and Traditional Crafts

The Next-Generation GST reforms recommended at the 56th GST Council meeting in September 2025 included measures supporting the handloom sector.

- Under the GST rationalisation, the tax rate on **36 handicraft items** was **reduced from 12% to 5%.**
- **Cotton handloom rugs** and **handwoven carpets** were also brought under the **5% GST** rate.
- **The rate on domestic and industrial sewing machines** was similarly **reduced from 12% to 5%,** easing costs for tailoring units and supporting domestic manufacturing.

IV. Union Budget 2026-27: A New Policy Push for India's Handlooms

The Union Budget 2026-27 placed special emphasis on textiles through several new measures:

- The **National Fibre Scheme** is designed to strengthen the textile raw-material base. It promotes self-reliance in natural, man-made and new-age fibres.
- Traditional clusters will be modernised under the **Textile Expansion and Employment Scheme**. It provides capital support for machinery, technology upgrades, and common testing and certification centres.
- The **National Handloom and Handicraft Programme** will integrate and strengthen existing schemes. This will ensure targeted support for both sectors.
- The **Mahatma Gandhi Gram Swaraj Initiative** will strengthen khadi, handloom and handicrafts while benefiting weavers, village industries, rural youth and the One District One Product (ODOP) initiative. It focuses **on global market linkages, branding, training, skilling, and improvements in production processes and quality**.

The ODOP Initiative promotes unique district products, balanced regional development and wider market access for local artisans and entrepreneurs.

Read more: One District One Product (ODOP): A Journey from Local Streets to Global Shelves

Reimagining Handloom through Design and Innovation

India's handloom traditions remain rooted in regional fibres, techniques, motifs and generations of weaving knowledge. At the same time, the platforms on which these textiles are presented are expanding. Supported by government institutions and initiatives, regional weaving traditions are reaching new platforms.

Several recent showcases illustrate how traditional textiles are being presented through contemporary design and wider cultural platforms.



DC Handlooms and **NIFT** unveiled ***Vishwa Sutra*** at the **61st Femina Miss India in April 2026.** Presented in Bhubaneswar, the collection brought together 30 handloom weaves across India. Each was reinterpreted through inspiration from 30 countries, combining textiles with international silhouettes and influences. These pairings placed Indian handlooms within a global design narrative while retaining authenticity and regional identities.



Breathing Threads brought handlooms into contemporary fashion at **Bharat Tex 2025.** It presented 30 looks using fabrics woven across five states. These fabrics came from West Bengal, Madhya Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh, Karnataka and Rajasthan. Chanderi, Maheshwari, Jamdani, Khun, Banarasi, Kota Doria and Murshidabad weaves gained contemporary expression through textures and cording.



At IFFI 2025 in Goa, DC Handlooms united couture, culture and cinema in ***Handloom Sarees in Motion: 70MM on Runway.*** The show traced Indian cinema's changing styles, from graceful 1940s drapes to experimental silhouettes of the 2020s. More than 40 sarees represented regional weaving traditions, including Tussar, Ikat Pashmina, Banarasi, Chanderi, Venkatagiri and Kuthampully. Several were hand-painted by award-winning artists using Pichwai, Pattachitra, Warli, Kalamkari, Madhubani, Gond and Bhil art.

Alongside these showcases, collaborative platforms are creating new spaces for experimentation across the handloom sector.

Expanding the Meaning of Design

- **Weave The Future 4.0:** Upcycling Edition of the event took place at Dilli Haat, New Delhi, from 12-17 July 2026. The exhibition brought together more than **100 brands, artisans, recyclers and innovators working in circular design.** It promoted upcycling, repair, sustainable production and responsible consumption.
- **Handloom Hackathon 2026:** Ministry of Textiles launched Handloom Hackathon 2026 – 'Weaving Innovation' for National Handloom Day 2026. **The challenge invites students, weavers, artisans, researchers, startups and professionals to develop practical solutions for the sector.** Its themes span design, sustainability, digital technology, market access, branding, productivity and entrepreneurship.

These appearances demonstrate the widening visibility of Indian handlooms. Through fashion shows, pageants, cinema, textile exhibitions and collaborative design platforms, regional weaves are entering broader cultural and creative spaces. This growing visibility forms part of a wider story that also encompasses market access and India's handloom export presence.

Strengthening Market Access and Buyer Confidence

Distinctive designs, small-batch production and eco-friendly processes have **created strong demand for handloom products in domestic and international markets.**

India's handloom exports stood at **~₹1,330.96 crore** in 2025-26. The leading export destinations during this period were **the UAE**, the **United States**, **France**, the **United Kingdom** and **Spain.**

As handloom products reach wider and more diverse markets, establishing their authenticity, quality and origin becomes increasingly important. **Government-supported marks, branding systems, GI registration and legal safeguards** help distinguish genuine handloom products and protect recognised weaving traditions. **Digital platforms** are also expanding market access.

- **Around 1.50 lakh weavers** and handloom entities have joined **GeM t**o supply government buyers.
- **Indiahandmade platform** enables verified weavers and producer groups to sell authentic products, including GI-tagged items, directly to consumers. The platform **onboarded 4,186 weavers & artisans between 2023-24 and June 2026.**



Handloom Mark: Establishing that a Product is Handwoven

Launched in 2006, the Handloom Mark scheme **gives handloom products a collective and distinctive identity.** It promotes handwoven goods while assuring buyers that the product they purchase is genuinely handwoven and helps identify the product or its manufacturer more easily.

- As of 30 June 2026, **29,402 Handloom Mark registrations have been issued** and;
- A total of **815 retail outlets** were selling products carrying the label

India Handloom Brand: Adding Quality Assurance

The India Handloom Brand was launched on the **first National Handloom Day on 7 August 2015**. It promotes niche handloom products with high quality, authentic traditional designs, zero defects and zero environmental impact. **The certification covers natural-fibre products with assured fast colours, skin-friendly dyes and social compliance**.

- By June 2026, **2,305 registrations** had been issued across **184 categories**.

GI Tags: Protecting the Identity of Regional Weaves

The **GI Act, 1999** protects registered geographical indications from unauthorised use. Registered users may approach police authorities against illegal manufacture or marketing, while State Handlooms and Textiles Departments have been advised to strengthen protection.

A **GI tag** identifies goods originating in a specific territory whose quality, reputation or characteristics are linked to that geographical origin.

- As reported in August 2026, registrations covered **106 handloom products, six product logos and 227 handicraft products.**

Legal Protection for Reserved Handloom Products

The **Handlooms Act, 1985** protects weavers and India's cultural heritage from encroachment by powerlooms and mills. **It reserves 11 specified textile articles for handloom production**.

Government agencies inspect powerloom units to prevent the production of items reserved exclusively for handlooms.

The Future is Handwoven

National Handloom Day 2026 offers a moment to look beyond the endurance of a tradition towards the possibilities ahead.

Indian handlooms carry the memory of place, community and skill, yet their story continues to find new expression with each generation. Their growing presence in contemporary life shows how heritage can remain relevant without losing its character.

As the world discovers more of India through its weaves, handloom continues to connect inherited knowledge with new aspirations. It carries regional identities from the hands of the weaver to a wider world.

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Research Unit
Press Information Bureau
Government of India

Intangible Cultural Heritage of India

Beyond Monuments and Landscapes

(Ministry of Culture)

July 15, 2024

The term 'cultural heritage' has changed content considerably in recent decades, partially owing to the instruments developed by UNESCO. Cultural heritage does not end at monuments and collections of objects. It also includes traditions or living expressions inherited from our ancestors and passed on to our descendants, such as oral traditions, performing arts, social practices, rituals, festive events, knowledge and practices concerning nature and the universe or the knowledge and skills to produce traditional crafts.



While fragile, intangible cultural heritage is an important factor in maintaining cultural diversity in the face of growing globalization. An understanding of the intangible cultural heritage of different communities helps with intercultural dialogue, and encourages mutual respect for other ways of life.

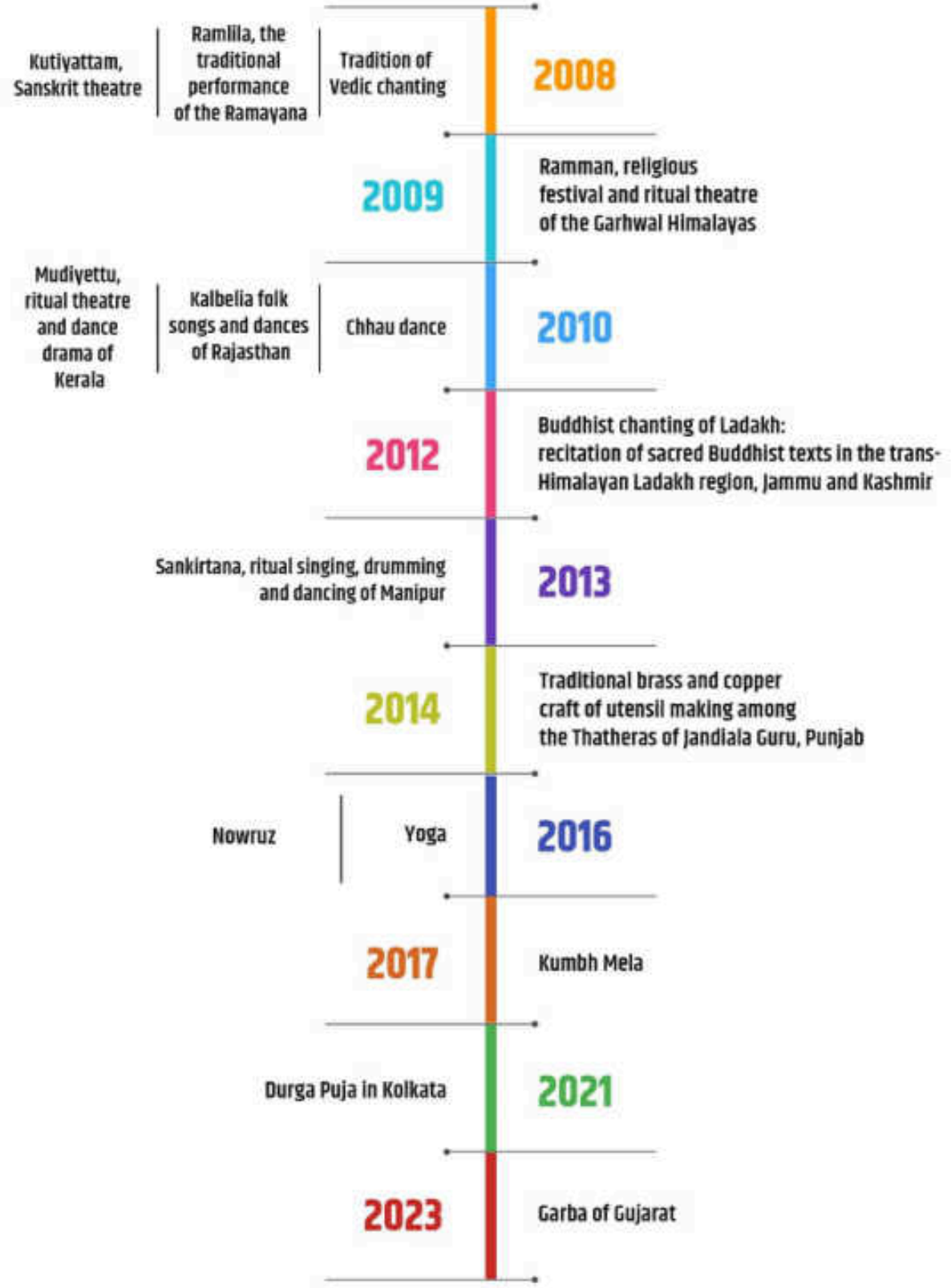
The importance of intangible cultural heritage is not the cultural manifestation itself but rather the wealth of knowledge and skills that is transmitted through it from one generation to the

next. The social and economic value of this transmission of knowledge is relevant for minority groups and for mainstream social groups within a State, and is as important for developing States as for developed ones.

The Intergovernmental Committee for the Safeguarding of the Intangible Cultural Heritage provides guidance on best practices and make recommendations on measures for the safeguarding of the intangible cultural heritage. The Committee is also in charge of granting international assistance. The Committee examines requests submitted by States Parties for the inscription of intangible heritage on the Lists as well as proposals for programmes and projects. The Committee meets annually to evaluate nominations proposed by States Parties to the 2003 Convention and decide whether or not to inscribe those cultural practices and expressions of intangible heritage on the Convention's Lists.

So far, **730 elements corresponding to 5 regions and 145 countries** have been listed as Intangible Cultural Heritage**. India has 15 elements included in this prestigious list**, all of which are part of the Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity.




Kutiyattam, Sanskrit theatre
Ramlila, the traditional performance of the Ramayana
Tradition of Vedic chanting
2008
2009
Ramman, religious festival and ritual theatre of the Garhwal Himalayas
Mudiyettu, ritual theatre and dance drama of Kerala
Kalbelia folk songs and dances of Rajasthan
Chhau dance
2010
2012
Buddhist chanting of Ladakh: recitation of sacred Buddhist texts in the trans-Himalayan Ladakh region, Jammu and Kashmir
Sankirtana, ritual singing, drumming and dancing of Manipur
2013
2014
Traditional brass and copper craft of utensil making among the Thatheras of Jandiala Guru, Punjab
Nowruz
Yoga
2016
2017
Kumbh Mela
Durga Puja in Kolkata
2021
2023
Garba of Gujarat

Garba of Gujarat



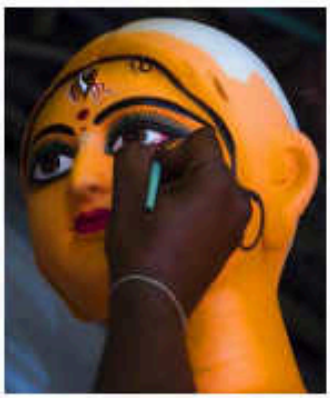


Year : 2023

Main Concept : *Dance, Ritual, Vocal Music*

Garba is a traditional dance performed during the Hindu festival of Navaratri, worshiping feminine energy or 'Shakti'. Dancers encircle a lit earthenware pot or an image of the goddess Amba, moving counter-clockwise with simple steps, clapping and singing in unison. Garba involves diverse participants such as dancers, musicians, craftspeople, and religious figures, fostering inclusivity across socio-economic and religious divides. Transmitted across generations through practice and observation, Garba also benefits from institutional support including workshops and courses in various related arts, further enriching its cultural significance and community bonds.

Durga Puja in Kolkata





Year : 2021

Main Concept : *Handicrafts, Sculpture*

Durga Puja is an annual festival celebrated primarily in Kolkata and other parts of India, dedicated to the worship of goddess Durga over ten days in September or October. Artisans sculpt clay images of Durga and her family months before the festival using river clay, which are then brought to life with painted eyes on the inaugural day of Mahalaya. The festival culminates with the immersion of these images in the Ganga River, symbolizing a return to one's roots. Durga Puja is renowned for its blend of religion and art, featuring elaborate installations, traditional drumming, and widespread community participation that bridges social divides of class, religion, and ethnicity.

Kumbh Mela





Year : 2017

Main Concept : *Pilgrimages. Religious Practice, Sacred Sites*

Kumbh Mela, the largest peaceful gathering of pilgrims globally, sees millions bathing in sacred rivers like the Ganges to cleanse themselves of sins and attain spiritual liberation. Held every four years in Allahabad, Haridwar, Ujjain, and Nasik, the festival attracts people from all walks of life, including ascetics, saints, and visitors, regardless of caste or creed. It combines astronomy, astrology, spirituality, and rich cultural traditions, imparted through ancient manuscripts, oral traditions, and the mentorship of sadhus in ashrams and akhadas. Kumbh Mela serves as a profound spiritual and cultural event, deeply influencing Indian society and showcasing its diversity.

Nowruz





Year : 2016

Main Concept : *Festivals, New Year, Prosperity Ritual*

March 21 marks the start of the year in Afghanistan, Azerbaijan, India, Iran (Islamic Republic of), Iraq, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Pakistan, Tajikistan, Turkey, Turkmenistan and Uzbekistan. It is referred to as Nowruz or Navroz in India, meaning 'new day' when a variety of rituals, ceremonies and other cultural events take place for a period of about two weeks. Families gather around a decorated table symbolizing purity and prosperity to share special meals. People wear new clothes, visit relatives, especially elders, and exchange gifts, often handmade by artisans. The festivities include music and dance performances, traditional sports, and the making of handicrafts, fostering cultural diversity and community solidarity. These traditions are passed down through generations, promoting tolerance and peace through active participation and observation.

Yoga





Year : 2016

Main Concept : *Mind, Physical Education, Spiritual Knowldge*

The philosophy of yoga, rooted in ancient Indian traditions, profoundly influences various aspects of society including health, education, and the arts. Yoga integrates mind, body, and soul through poses, meditation, controlled breathing, and chanting, promoting mental, spiritual, and physical wellbeing. Practiced by people of all ages and backgrounds, yoga transcends gender, class, and religion, gaining popularity worldwide. Traditional transmission through the Guru-Shishya model continues in ashrams, schools, universities, and online platforms, supported by ancient manuscripts and modern literature, enriching its practice and teaching.

Traditional Brass and Copper Craft of Utensil Making among the Thatheras of Jandiala Guru, Punjab





Year : 2014

Main Concept : *Metal Working, Technical Skills*

The craft of the Thatheras of Jandiala Guru in Punjab is a traditional art form centered around handcrafting brass and copper utensils. This intricate process involves flattening cooled metal cakes into thin plates, hammering them into various shapes using wood-fired stoves for precise temperature control, and finishing them with polishing techniques using sand and tamarind juice. Passed down orally from generation to generation, this craft not only sustains livelihoods but also defines family traditions and social status within their community, serving both utilitarian and ritualistic purposes in daily life and special occasions.

Sankirtana, ritual singing, drumming and dancing of Manipur





Year : 2013

Main Concept : *Dance, Rituals, Vocal Music*

Sankirtana is a vibrant tradition among the Vaishnava community in the Manipur plains, involving song and dance performances that narrate the life of Krishna. Typically held in temples or courtyards with two drummers and about ten singer-dancers, these performances evoke deep religious and aesthetic sentiments, often moving spectators to tears or reverence. Sankirtana serves dual roles: it unites the community during festive occasions and strengthens social bonds through life-cycle ceremonies. This practice is integral to Manipuri culture, emphasizing community participation and the transmission of knowledge from mentors to disciples, while maintaining harmony with the natural world through its rituals.

Buddhist chanting of Ladakh: Recitation of Sacred Buddhist texts in the trans-Himalayan Ladakh Region





Year : 2012

Main Concept : *Buddhism, Religious Practice, Vocal Music*

In Ladakh, Buddhist lamas perform sacred chanting rooted in Mahayana and Vajrayana traditions, practiced across four major sects: Nyngma, Kagyud, Shakya, and Geluk. Chanting serves spiritual and moral purposes, performed during life-cycle rituals and important Buddhist and agrarian events. Chants are conducted in groups, accompanied by symbolic gestures (mudras) and traditional instruments like bells and drums. Acolytes undergo rigorous training under senior monks, memorizing texts through frequent recitation. These daily chants in monastery halls are prayers for world peace and personal spiritual growth.

Chhau Dance





Year	**:** 2010
Main Concept	**:** *Acrobats, Dance, Hinduism, Representative Literary Works*

Chhau dance, originating from eastern India, encompasses narratives from epics, folklore, and abstract themes, distinguished by styles from Seraikella, Purulia, and Mayurbhanj. It incorporates mock combat, bird and animal movements, and village household gestures, taught primarily to male dancers from traditional artist families or local communities. Performed at night with traditional music including reed pipes and drums, Chhau plays a vital role in local festivals and cultural identity, yet faces challenges from modernization and economic pressures that threaten community participation and heritage preservation.

Kalbelia Folk Songs and Dances of Rajasthan





Year : 2010

Main Concept : *Dance, Intrumental Music, Vocal Music*

Kalbelia songs and dances, once practiced by snake handlers, now celebrate their cultural heritage through music and movement. Women adorned in black skirts emulate serpentine motions while men play traditional instruments like the khanjari and poongi. These performances, rich with mythological narratives and improvisational poetry, are integral to Kalbelia identity, conveying stories and traditions orally across generations amidst societal changes and challenges to their traditional lifestyle.

Mudiyettu, Ritual Theatre and Dance Drama of Kerala





Year : 2010

Main Concept : *Dance, Religious Practice, Theatre*

Mudiyettu is a ritual dance drama from Kerala depicting the battle between goddess Kali and the demon Darika, involving the entire village community. Performers purify themselves through fasting and prayer before invoking the goddess within a large, ritualistic drawing called kalam. Held annually at Bhagavati Kavus temples across different villages, Mudiyettu

fosters mutual cooperation and community bonding while transmitting cultural values and traditions from elders to younger generations.

Ramman, Religious Festival and Ritual Theatre of the Garhwal Himalayas





Year : 2009

Main Concept : *Festivals, Hinduism, Theatre*

Ramman is an annual religious festival held in late April in Saloor-Dungra, Uttarakhand, dedicated to Bhumiyal Devta, a local deity. The festival features complex rituals including recitations of the epic of Rama, legends, songs, and masked dances. Organized by villagers, each caste and occupational group plays a distinct role, with Brahmans leading prayers and rituals, and Bhandaris wearing sacred masks like that of Narasimha. Ramman combines theatre, music, and historical narratives, reflecting the community's environmental, spiritual, and cultural ethos, and reinforcing its identity through mythological tales. Efforts are underway to preserve and promote Ramman beyond its local context to ensure its cultural continuity and broader recognition.

Kutiyattam, Sanskrit Theatre





Year : 2008

Main Concept : *Dance, Religious Art, Theatre*

Kutiyattam, Sanskrit theatre, which is practised in the province of Kerala, is one of India's oldest living theatrical traditions, originating more than 2,000 years ago. It emphasizes meticulous eye expressions and gestures to convey characters' thoughts and emotions. Actors undergo rigorous training lasting up to fifteen years, mastering intricate breathing techniques and muscle control. Traditionally staged in temple theatres with sacred rituals, Kutiyattam has faced challenges due to historical shifts in patronage, leading to recent funding crises. Efforts are underway among various stakeholders to preserve and sustain this cultural treasure amidst modern challenges.

Ramlila, The Traditional Performance of the Ramayana





Year : 2008

Main Concept : *Epic Poetry, Theatre*

Ramlila, a traditional performance of the Ramayana epic, takes place across northern India during the Dussehra festival. Based on the Ramacharitmanas, composed by Tulsidas in the

16th century, Ramlilas span ten to twelve days in most places but can extend to a month in places like Ramnagar. These performances narrate episodes from the Ramayana, celebrating Rama's return from exile and depicting his battle with Ravana. Despite its cultural significance in uniting communities regardless of caste or religion, Ramlila faces declining attendance due to the popularity of television dramas. Efforts are needed to preserve and promote this cultural tradition amidst modern challenges.

Tradition of Vedic Chanting





Year	: 2008
Main Concept	: *Oral Tradition, Religious Belief, Vocal Music, Representative Literary Works,*

The Vedas, composed by Aryans over 3,500 years ago, are foundational texts in Hinduism, revered for their philosophical depth, rituals, and hymns. Comprising four main texts—the Rig Veda, Sama Veda, Yajur Veda, and Atharva Veda—they were traditionally chanted during rituals and daily life in Vedic communities. These texts provide insights into early Hindu history, artistic and scientific concepts, and the development of classical Sanskrit. Despite their enduring cultural significance, only thirteen of the original over one thousand Vedic recitation branches survive today, with several schools facing the risk of extinction. Efforts are ongoing to preserve this ancient oral tradition amidst contemporary challenges.

In conclusion, these living expressions, passed down through generations, play a vital role in fostering intercultural dialogue and mutual respect among communities worldwide. Recognizing and safeguarding intangible cultural heritage not only preserves cultural identity but also promotes social cohesion and sustainable development. Through initiatives like

BACKGROUNDERS
Press Information Bureau
Government of India

Reforming India's Tribunal System

Tribunal Reforms Bill, 2026

August 12, 2026

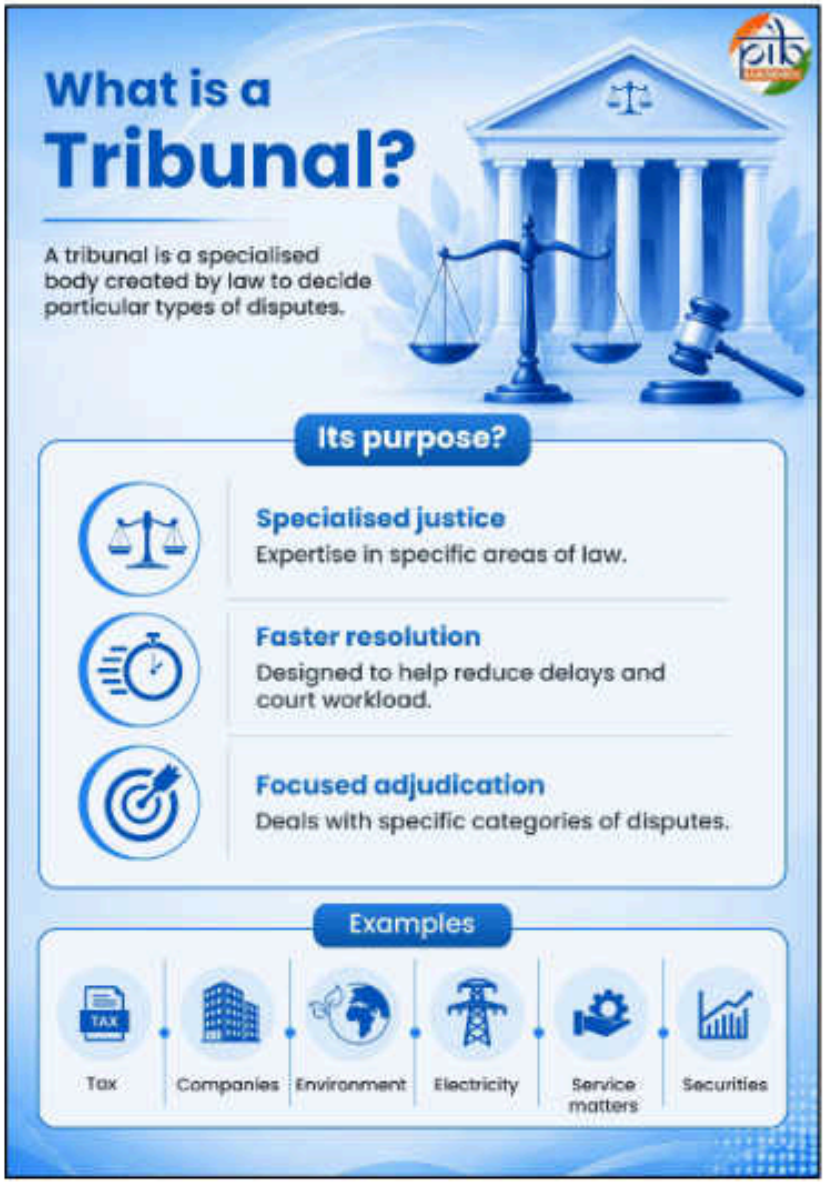
The Tribunals Reforms Bill, 2026 seeks to create a more independent, transparent and professionally administered tribunal system. The Bill provides for setting up of a judiciary-led National Tribunals Commission that will make selections to the tribunals and exercise oversight on their functioning. The aim is to reduce executive discretion while strengthening accountability. By creating a common institutional framework for tribunal administration, the Bill seeks to address longstanding concerns over appointments, tenure and functioning, while giving effect to the principles laid down by the Supreme Court in its Madras Bar Association judgments.

Strengthening India's Tribunal System

The Tribunal Reforms Bill, 2026 passed by the Parliament in August 2026, aims to reform the tribunal system to make it more **efficient, independent of the executive, transparent and uniform.**

The Bill follows various Supreme Court judgements on the independence of tribunals. In ***Madras Bar Association v. Union of India*** [(2026) 2 SCC 1], the Supreme Court struck down provisions of the Tribunals Reforms Act, 2021. The Court also directed the establishment of an independent National Tribunals Commission.

The **2026 Bill proposes to repeal the Tribunal Reforms Act, 2021**. It introduces a new structure to ensure that the system is independent yet accountable to the people it serves.



Covered Tribunals & Governing Acts

The Bill lists all the **Tribunals, Appellate Tribunals, and Authorities** governed by the bill, alongside their corresponding **Enactments**. The changes proposed by the Bill shall apply to these tribunals.

Sl. No.	Tribunal / Appellate Tribunal / Authority	Enactments
1.	*Customs, Excise and Service Tax Appellate Tribunal*	The Customs Act, 1962 (52 of 1962)
2.	*Appellate Tribunal*	The Smugglers and Foreign Exchange Manipulators (Forfeiture of Property) Act, 1976 (13 of 1976)

3.	*Central Administrative Tribunal*	The Administrative Tribunals Act, 1985 (13 of 1985)
4.	*State Administrative Tribunals*	The Administrative Tribunals Act, 1985 (13 of 1985)
5.	*Railway Claims Tribunal*	The Railway Claims Tribunal Act, 1987 (54 of 1987)
6.	*Securities Appellate Tribunal*	The Securities and Exchange Board of India Act, 1992 (15 of 1992)
7.	*Debts Recovery Tribunal*	The Recovery of Debts and Bankruptcy Act, 1993 (51 of 1993)
8.	*Debts Recovery Appellate Tribunal*	The Recovery of Debts and Bankruptcy Act, 1993 (51 of 1993)
9.	*Telecom Disputes Settlement and Appellate Tribunal*	The Telecom Regulatory Authority of India Act, 1997 (24 of 1997)
10.	*Appellate Tribunal for Electricity*	The Electricity Act, 2003 (36 of 2003)
11.	*Armed Forces Tribunal*	The Armed Forces Tribunal Act, 2007 (55 of 2007)
12.	*National Green Tribunal*	The National Green Tribunal Act, 2010 (19 of 2010)
13.	*National Company Law Appellate Tribunal*	The Companies Act, 2013 (18 of 2013)
14.	*National Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission*	The Consumer Protection Act, 2019 (35 of 2019)
15.	*Industrial Tribunal constituted by the Central Government*	The Industrial Relations Code, 2020 (35 of 2020)
16.	*Income-tax Appellate Tribunal*	The Income-tax Act, 2025 (30 of 2025)

A New National Tribunals Commission

The 2026 Bill aims at protecting the independence of the tribunals system through the establishment of a new **National Tribunals Commission (NTC)**. This commission, which will be **dominated by the high-ranking members of the judiciary**, replaces the Central Government, which was given the charge of making key appointments and services conditions according to the Tribunal Reforms Act, 2021.

Composition of the Commission

The Commission would consist of:

- A Chairperson who has been a Judge of the Supreme Court or a Chief Justice of a High Court, and
- Four Members:
  - Two shall be Judicial Members who have been Chief Justice or Judge of a High Court
  - Two shall be Technical Members with at least 25 years of experience in the fields of public administration, finance, law, accountancy, banking, management, or technology.



The Central Government will formally appoint the Chairperson and the Judicial Members of the Commission. However, it must consult the Chief Justice of India before appointing the Chairperson and Judicial Members.

Functions of the Commission

Under the **Tribunals Reforms Bill, 2026**, the National Tribunals Commission (NTC) has several important roles:

- **Conduct selections:** Conduct the selection process for filling up the vacancies of Chairpersons and Members of the Tribunals through Search-cum-Selection Committees.
- **Review performance:** Monitor tribunal performance and prepares annual reports to be submitted to the Central Government.
- **Oversee inquiries:** Supervise inquiries into complaints against tribunal members.
- **Maintain data:** Develops and maintains the National Tribunals Data Grid, which is a portal containing the repository of all case-related information pertaining to the 16 tribunals.

Term of Service

- The Chairperson of the Commission or a Member of the Commission shall hold office for a term of five years or till he attains the age of seventy years, whichever is earlier
- A Member of a Tribunal shall hold office for a term of five years or till he attains the age of sixty-seven years, whichever is earlier.

The framework also allows reappointment, with previous service and performance considered during the selection process.

New Secretariat

The **Secretariat** serves as the administrative support system for the National Tribunals Commission. The Secretariat will be headed by a Secretary to the Government of India. Its other officers and employees, including their number and service conditions, will be prescribed by rules. It will function under the general and administrative oversight of the Commission's Chairperson. It:

- **Empanels experts:** Identifies and empanels experts from relevant fields to assess candidates.
- **Communicates recommendations:** Sends the Search-cum-Selection Committee's recommendations to the Central Government within **three days**.
- **Provides administrative support:** Supports the Commission and carries out functions prescribed.
- **Prepares annual reports:** Prepares an annual report yearly giving full and true account of the activities of the Commission and forward the report to the Central government.
-

Search-cum-Selection Committees

The selection of Chairpersons and Members to various tribunals will be done through **Search-cum-Selection Committees.** These committees will be responsible for evaluating candidates and recommending appointments to tribunal posts.

Under **Section 13 of the Tribunals Reforms Bill, 2026**, the Search-cum-Selection Committee comprises:
For selecting a Tribunal Chairperson

1. **Chairperson of the National Tribunals Commission**
2. **Technical Member of the Commission**
3. **Retired Chief Justice of a High Court**, nominated by the Commission Chairperson
4. **Secretary to the Government of India**, nominated by the Central Government. In case of appointment to the post of Chairperson of the State Administrative Tribunals, the Chief Secretary to the State Government concerned shall be the Member
5. **Two empanelled experts** who assessed the candidates
6. **Secretary of the Commission** — Member Secretary

For selecting a Tribunal Member:

1. **Judicial Member of the National Tribunals Commission** — Committee Chair
2. **Technical Member of the Commission**
3. **Retired High Court Judge**, nominated by the Commission Chairperson
4. **Secretary to the Government of India**, nominated by the Central Government. In case of appointment to the post of Member of the State Administrative Tribunals, the Chief Secretary to the State Government concerned shall be the Member
5. **Two empanelled experts** who assessed the candidates
6. **Secretary of the Commission** — Member Secretary

The Committee Chair has the **casting vote**, while the **Member Secretary and expert Members do not have voting rights**. The Committee:

- **Selects candidates:** Conducts the selection process for Chairpersons and Members.
- **Recommends candidates:** The Committee recommends **one suitable candidate for each vacancy** and one additional candidate for the waiting list.
- **Considers past performance:** For candidates seeking reappointment, the Committee considers their previous service and performance.
- **Facilitates timely appointments:** Recommendations are sent to the Central Government through the Secretariat, which must communicate them within **three days**. The Government must process the recommendation and make the appointment within **three months**.

The proposed National Tribunals Commission has a judicial majority. Its Search-cum-Selection Committees are also judicially chaired. The judicial Chairperson has the casting vote. The Committee recommends a single candidate rather than a panel of names. This strengthens judicial influence over the selection process while limiting executive discretion.

Financial and Administrative Independence

The Bill seeks to give tribunals greater financial and administrative autonomy. Under this framework, individual tribunals will identify their requirements for funds, staff, and premises. The Commission's Secretariat will consolidate these projections, and the Commission will evaluate them using an objective framework to determine overall allocation needs.

The Central Government will continue to allocate the necessary grants following parliamentary appropriation.To ensure financial accountability and transparency, the Comptroller and Auditor-General of India (CAG) will audit the accounts of the Commission and forward the audit report to the Central Government, which will then lay it before both Houses of Parliament.



Towards a More Independent Tribunal System

The **Tribunals Reforms Bill, 2026** seeks to establish judicial independence and transparency in the tribunals system. While the Bill reinforces judicial independence, it balances this by keeping the system accountable to the public through parliamentary oversight.

The proposed National Tribunals Commission creates a permanent institutional mechanism for appointments, performance review and disciplinary oversight. Judicially led selection committees strengthen the judicial element in appointments. Expert assessment places greater emphasis on professional competence. Five-year tenure provides greater stability.

The Bill marks a shift from fragmented, executive-driven tribunal rules to a structured institutional framework. Its core goal is to establish a more independent, transparent, and professionally managed system that aligns with the Supreme Court's Madras Bar Association jurisprudence.

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PIB Research

Annexure-I

INDIA: WORLD HERITAGE SITES

Sl. No.	Site	State	Year
1.	Agra Fort	Uttar Pradesh	1983
2.	Ajanta Caves	Maharashtra	1983
3.	Ellora Caves	Maharashtra	1983
4.	Taj Mahal	Uttar Pradesh	1983
5.	Group of Monuments at Mahabalipuram	Tamil Nadu	1984
6.	Sun Temple, Konarak	Odisha	1984
7.	Kaziranga National Park	Assam	1985
8.	Keoladeo National Park	Rajasthan	1985
9.	Manas Wildlife Sanctuary	Assam	1985

10.	Churches and Convents	Goa	1986
11.	Fatehpur Sikri	Uttar Pradesh	1986
12.	Group of Monuments at Hampi	Karnataka	1986
13.	Khajuraho Group of Monuments	Madhya Pradesh	1986
14.	Elephanta Caves	Maharashtra	1987
15.	Great Living Chola Temples at Thanjavur, Gangaikondacholapuran and Darasuram	Tamil Nadu	1987 & 2004
16.	Group of Monuments at Pattadakal	Karnataka	1987
17.	Sundarbans National Park	West Bengal	1987
18.	Nanda Devi and Valley of Flowers National Parks	Uttarakhand	1988 & 2005
19.	Buddhist Monuments at Sanchi	Madhya Pradesh	1989
20.	Humayun's Tomb	Delhi	1993

21.	QutbMinar and its Monuments	Delhi	1993
22.	22a Mountain Railway of India (Darjeeling) 22b Nilgiri 22c Kalka - Shimla	West Bengal Tamil Nadu Himachal Pradesh	1999 2005 2008
23.	Mahabodhi Temple Complex at Bodh Gaya	Bihar	2002
24.	Rock Shelters of Bhimbetka	Madhya Pradesh	2003
25.	Champaner - Pavagadh Archaeological Park	Gujarat	2004
26.	Chhatrapati Shivaji Terminus (formerly Victoria Terminus)	Maharashtra	2004
27.	Red Fort Complex	Delhi	2007
28.	The Jantar Mantar, Jaipur	Rajasthan	2010
29.	Western Ghats	Karnataka, Kerala, Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu	2012

30.	Hill Forts of Rajasthan 30a Chittorgarh 30b Kumbhalgarh 30c Jaisalmer 30d Ranthambhore 30e Amber 30fGagron	Rajasthan	2013
31.	Rani-ki-Vav (the Queen's Stepwell) at Patan	Gujarat	2014
32.	Great Himalayan National Park Conservation Area	Himachal Pradesh	2014
33.	Archeological Site of Nalanda Mahavihara at Nalanda	Bihar	2016
34.	The Architectural Work of Le Corbusier, an Outstanding Contribution to the Modern Movement	Chandigarh	2016
35.	Khangchendzonga National Park	Sikkim	2016
36.	Historic City of Ahmadabad	Gujarat	2017
37.	Victorian Gothic and Art Deco Ensembles of Mumbai	Maharashtra	2018

38.	Jaipur City	Rajasthan	2019
39.	Dholavira: a Harappan City	Gujarat	2021
40.	Kakatiya Rudreshwara (Ramappa) Temple	Telangana	2021
41.	Santiniketan, India	West Bengal	2023
42.	Sacred Ensemble of Hoysalas	Karnataka	2023
43.	Moidams – the Mound-Burial System of the Ahom Dynasty	Assam	2024

(Release ID: 2043018) Visitor Counter : 250

PRADHAN MANTRI KISAN SAMMAN NIDHI SCHEME

(PM-KISAN SCHEME)

OPERATIONAL GUIDELINES

(REVISED AS ON 29.03.2020)

MINISTRY OF AGRICULTURE & FARMERS' WELFARE

DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE, COOPERATION & FARMERS' WELFARE

(DAC&FW)

PRADHAN MANTRI KISAN SAMMAN NIDHI (PM-KISAN) SCHEME

OPERATIONAL GUIDELINES

1. Scheme

With a view to provide income support to all landholding farmers' families in the country, having cultivable land, the Central Government has implemented a Central Sector Scheme, namely, **"Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi (PM-KISAN)"**.

2. Objective and Benefits

The scheme aims to supplement the financial needs of all landholding farmers' families in procuring various inputs to ensure proper crop health and appropriate yields, commensurate with the anticipated farm income as well as for domestic needs. Under the Scheme an amount of Rs.6000/- per year is released by the Central Government online directly into the bank accounts of the eligible farmers under Direct Benefit Transfer mode, subject to certain exclusions.

3. Definition of farmer's family

A landholder farmer's family is defined as "a family comprising of husband, wife and minor children who owns cultivable land as per land records of the concerned State/UT". The existing land-ownership system will be used for identification of beneficiaries for calculation of benefit.

4 Exclusions

4.1 The following categories of beneficiaries of higher economic status shall not be eligible for benefit under the scheme:

(a) All Institutional Land holders; and

(b) Farmer families in which one or more of its members belong to following categories :

i) Former and present holders of constitutional posts

ii) Former and present Ministers / State Ministers and former / present Members of Lok Sabha / Rajya Sabha / State Legislative Assemblies / State Legislative Councils, former and present Mayors of Municipal Corporations, former and present Chairpersons of District Panchayats.

iii) All serving or retired officers and employees of Central / State Government Ministries / Offices / Departments and their field units, Central or State PSEs and Attached offices / Autonomous Institutions under Government as well as regular

employees of the Local Bodies *(Excluding Multi Tasking Staff / Class IV / Group D employees)*

iv) All superannuated / retired pensioners whose monthly pension is Rs.10,000/- or more *(Excluding Multi Tasking Staff / Class IV / Group D employees)*

v) All Persons who paid Income Tax in last assessment year.

vi) Professionals like Doctors, Engineers, Lawyers, Chartered Accountants, and Architects registered with Professional bodies and carrying out profession by undertaking practices.

(c) In case of new beneficiaries being uploaded on the PM-KISAN Portal, all land holding farmers' families who are Non-resident Indians (NRIs) in terms of the provisions of the Income Tax Act, 1961 shall be excluded from any benefit under the Scheme.

4.2 For the purpose of exclusion State / UT Governments can certify the eligibility of the beneficiaries based on self declaration by the beneficiaries. In case beneficiary is not available / does not reside in the village, State / UT Governments may consider certification based on the declaration by other adult member of his / her family. In case of incorrect self declaration, beneficiary shall be liable for recovery of transferred financial benefit and other penal actions as per law.

5. Methodology for calculation of benefit

5.1 The benefit shall be paid to only those farmers' families whose names are entered into the land records. Exception has, however, been made for North-East States and Jharkhand in this regard.

5.2 The cut-off date for determination of eligibility of beneficiaries under the scheme shall be 01.02.2019 and no changes thereafter shall be considered for eligibility of benefit under the scheme for next 5 years. However, this date is not applicable when transfer of ownership of cultivable land takes place on account of succession due to death.

5.3 Benefit will be allowed in those cases where transfer of ownership of cultivable land takes place on account of succession due to death of the landowner. However, those eligible farmers whose names have been entered in the land record after 01.12.2018 till 01.02.2019 shall be eligible for the benefits from the date of entry of land rights in the land records. In such cases where, transfer of ownership of cultivable land has happened due to any reason which could be purchase, succession, will, gift, etc., between 01.12.2018 and 31.01.2019, the installment pertaining to the 4-monthly period / trimester December, 2018 - March, 2019 during the financial year (2018-19) shall be proportionate amount from date of transfer till 31.03.2019 with respect to the 4 months period.

5.3.1 In cases where the land records have not been updated for rights accruing due to succession on account of the death of land owners before 01.12.2018, such updation of land records may be done by the States in a time bound manner. The successors